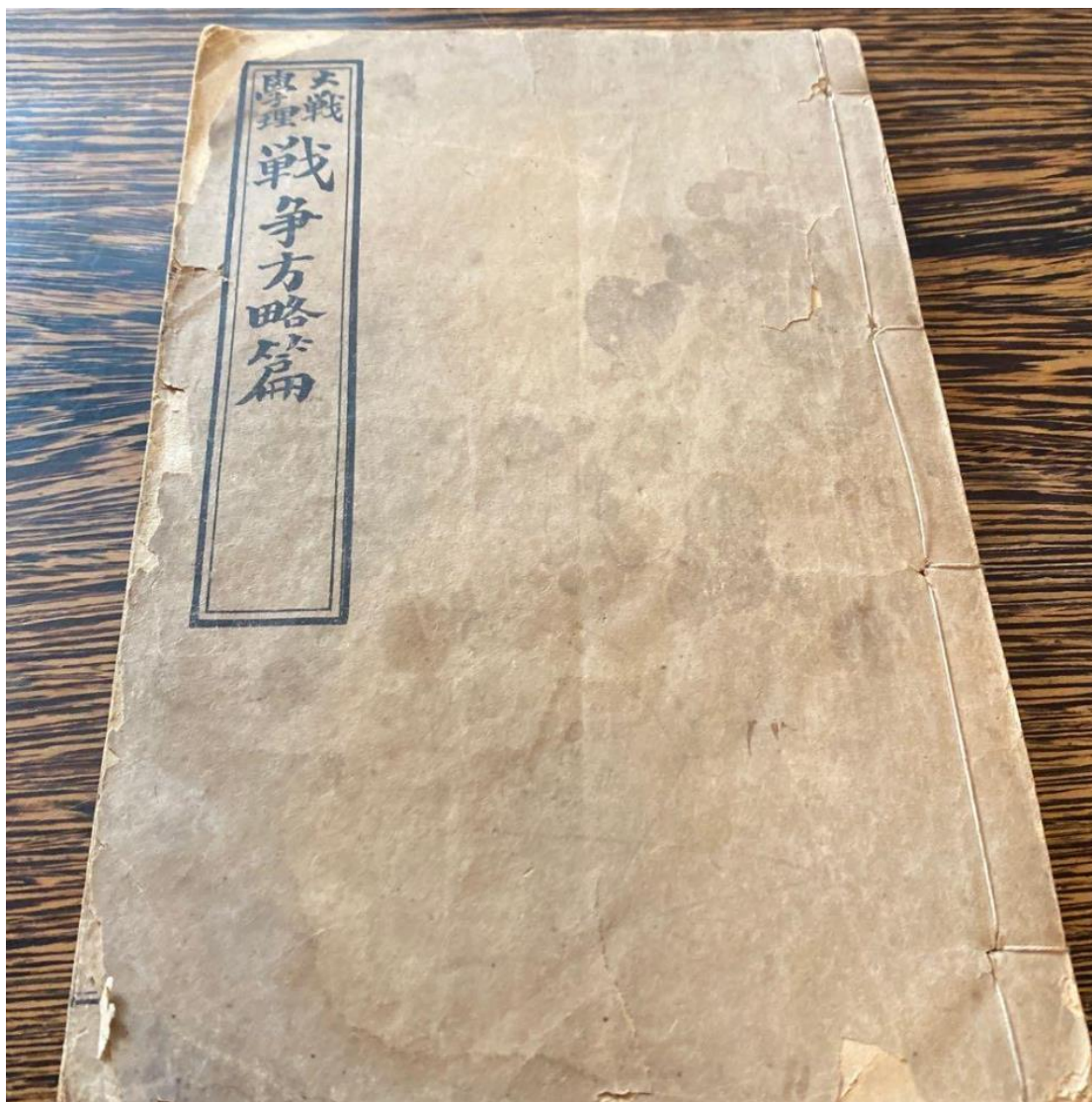
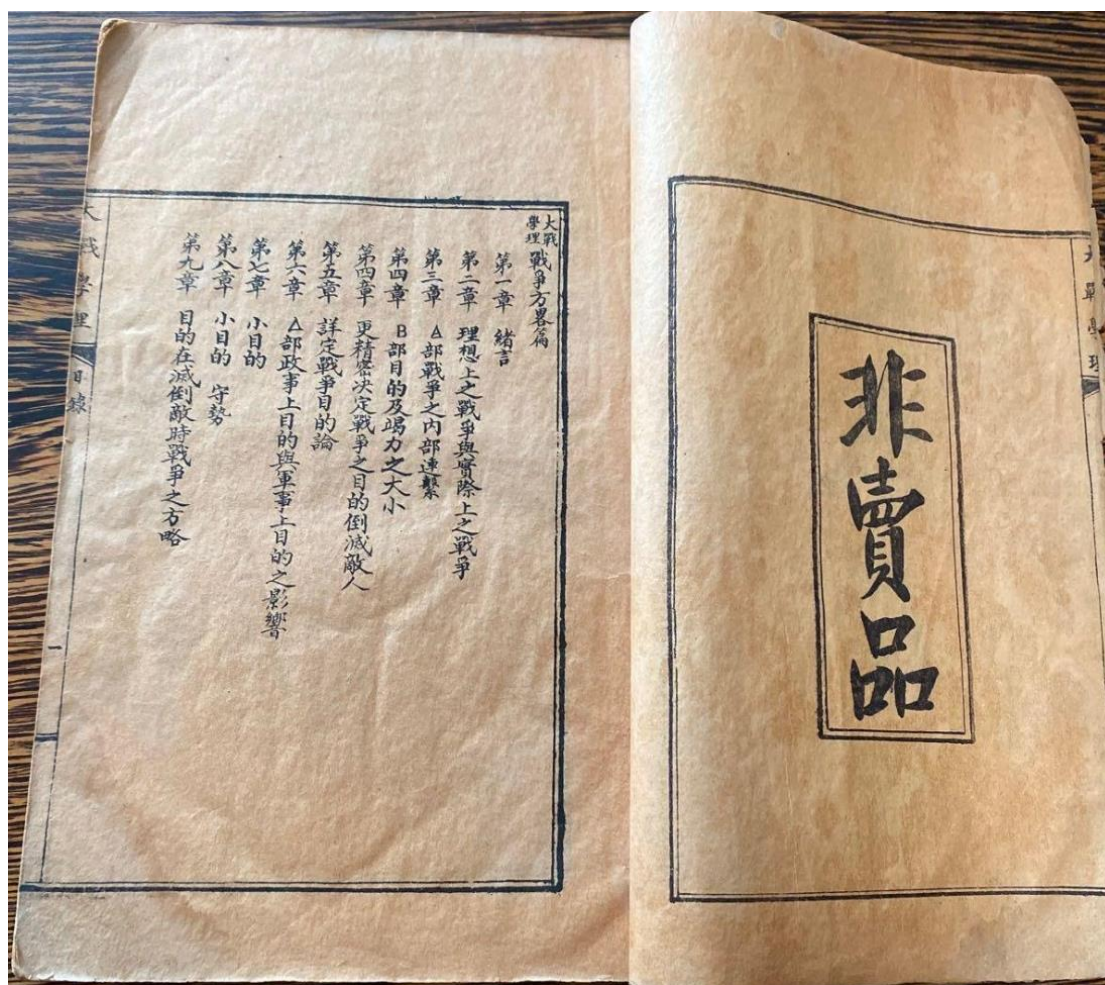


At the beginning of the 20th century, *On War* was introduced into China via Japan. As early as 1911, a Chinese translation of *On War* titled "大战学理" (The Academic Theory of Major Operations) was published. This version was adapted from the Japanese translation used at the Imperial Japanese Army Academy. The first six books were translated by the Military Advisory Office of the late Qing Dynasty, while the final two books were supplemented and translated by He Runshan (何润珊, Ho Jun-shan) and Qu Xiangheng (瞿湘衡, Ch'ü Hsiang-heng). Notably, the original author's name remained untranslated in this edition. Circulated only for limited research purposes, the translation was never officially released for sale. And there are currently no physical photographs of this edition available.



Presumably the 1911 edition, with the cover titled *Plan of War* (Book VIII).



The left page contains the table of contents, and the right page is marked "Not for Sale".

In the winter of 1912, the Guangdong Military Research Society reprinted the revised edition based on the translation produced by the Military Advisory Office, yet the original author was merely marked as "苦路疏意志". No physical photographs of this edition available.

In August 1915, Qu Shouti (瞿寿禔, Ch'ü Shou-t'i) completed another indirect translation of *On War* based on the Japanese version used by the Imperial Japanese Army Academy. Adopting the title "大战学理", he translated the work independently, with the original author recorded only as "格鲁塞威止". This translation was officially published and publicly distributed for the first time in China by Zhonghua Book Company, Shanghai. No physical photographs of this edition available.

Later, the Army University reprinted Qu's translation and retitled the book "战争学理" (The Academic Theory of War). The original author was rendered as "克劳塞维茨", a translation still used across mainland China, Hong Kong, Macao and Taiwan to this day. No publication date was indicated in this reprint. No physical photographs of this edition available.

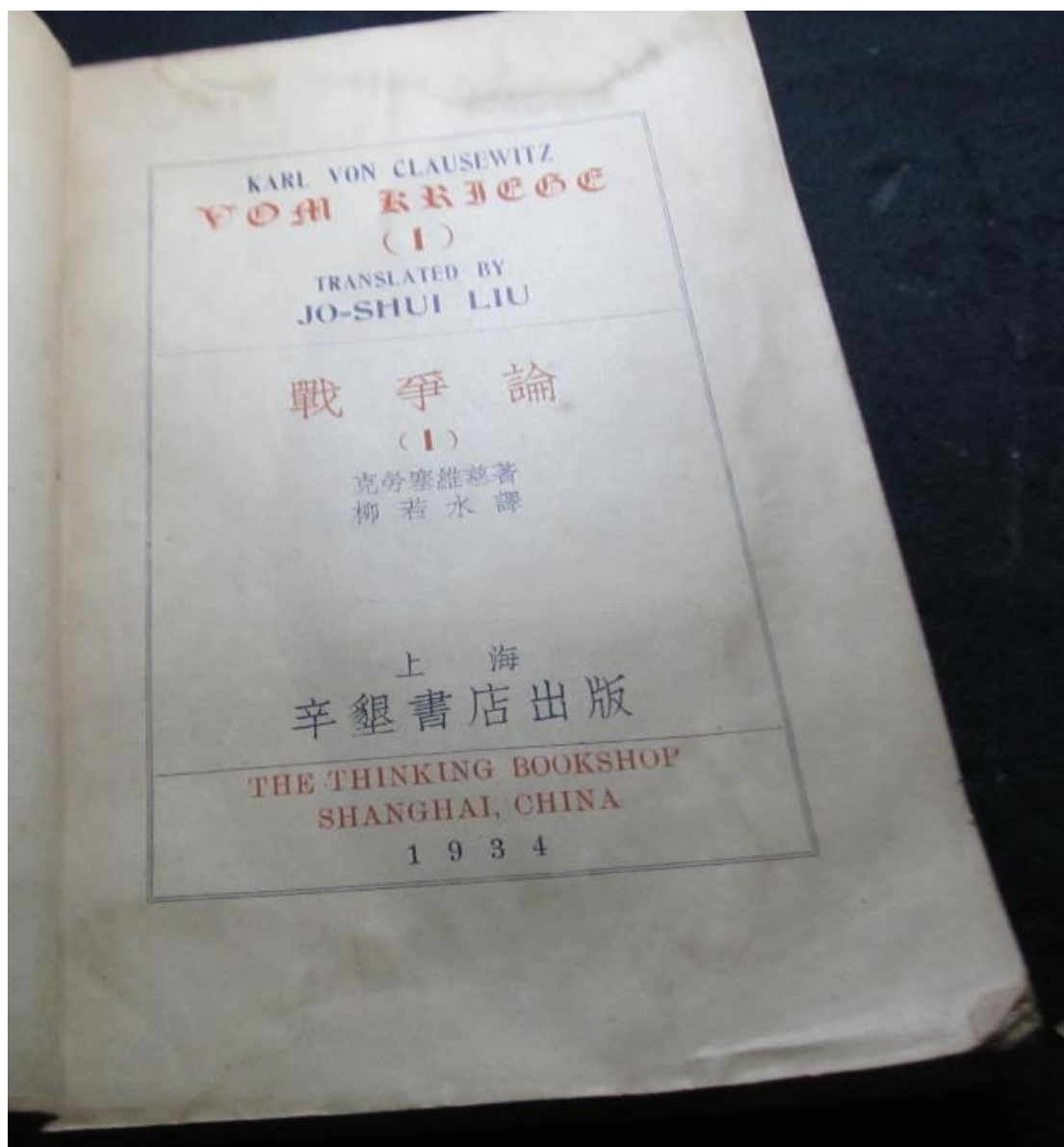
In May 1934, Liu Ruoshui (柳若水, Liu Jo-shui) translated indirectly from the Japanese version rendered by Magome Kensuke (马込健之助, 馬込 健之助). He adopted the official title "战争论" which means On War, and translated the author's name as "克劳塞维茨". This edition was published by Xinken Bookstore in Shanghai.



The two-volume Japanese translation by Magome Kennosuke, Sixth Edition, 1940; the first edition was published in 1933.



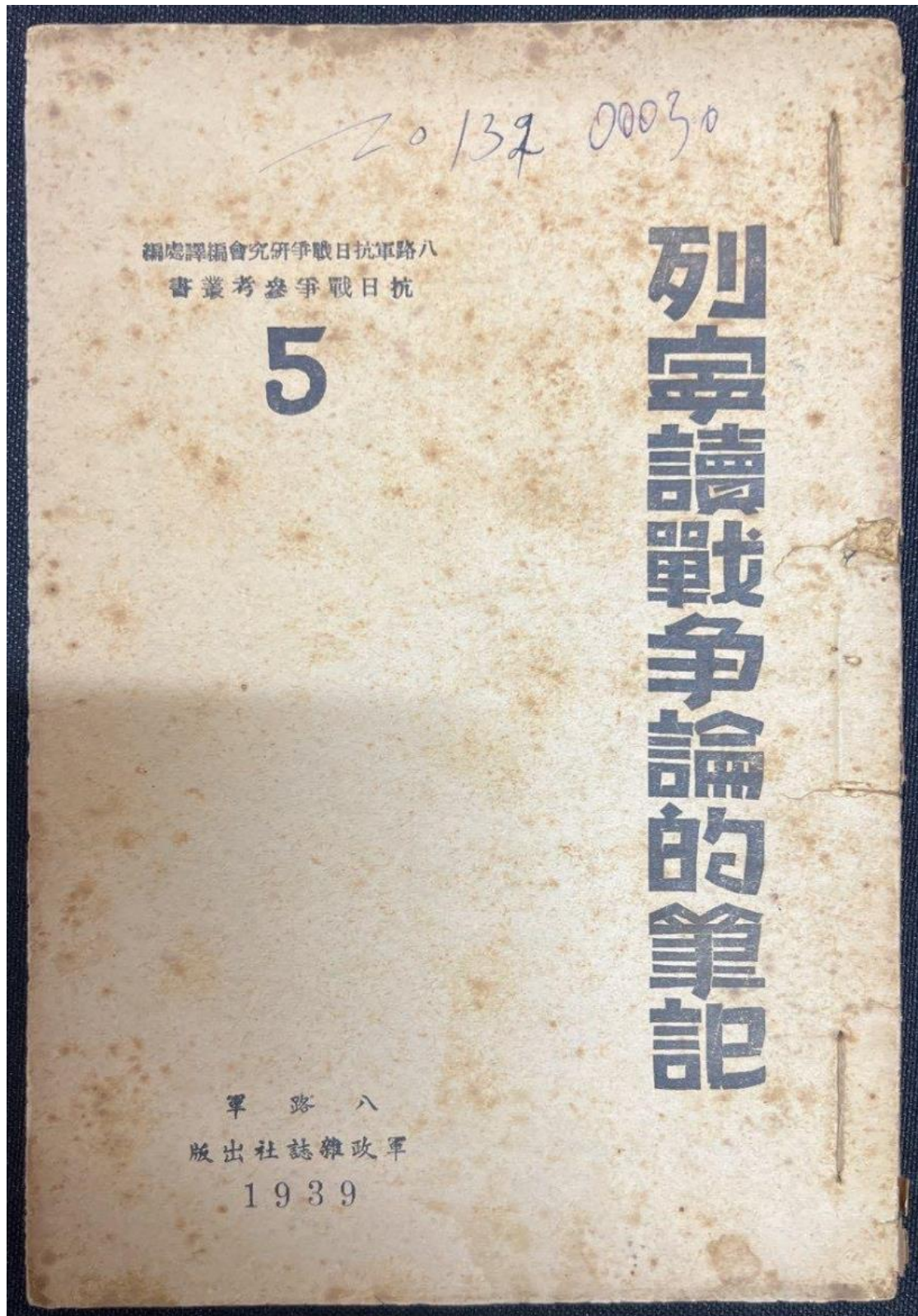
The 1934 edition, Volume 1 (Only the first volume has been located; the total number of volumes remains unknown; maybe two-volume).



Half-title page of the 1934 edition.

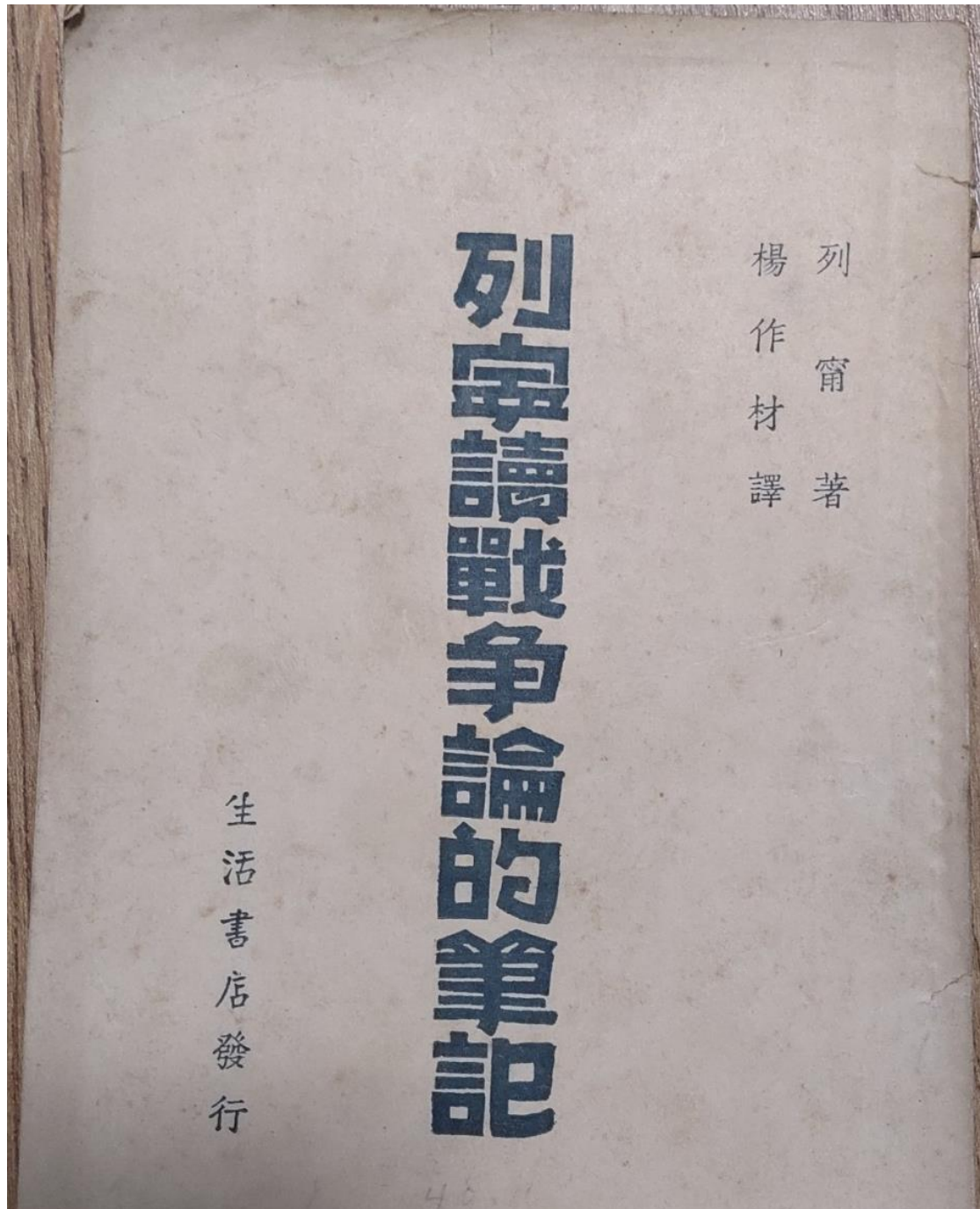
In June 1937, Yang Yanchang (杨言昌, Yang Yen-ch'ang) retranslated the work based on the 1939 Japanese translation by Magome Kennosuke. No physical photographs of this edition available.

In 1939, the Military and Political Journal Press of the Eighth Route Army — the Chinese Workers' and Peasants' Red Army during the War of Resistance against Japanese Aggression and the predecessor of the Chinese People's Liberation Army — published *Lenin's Notes on Reading On War*.



Lenin's Notes on Reading On War, the 1939 edition.

In 1940, Life Bookstore published Yang Zuocai (杨作才, Yang Tso-ts'ai)'s translation of *Lenin's Notes on Reading On War*.



Lenin's Notes on Reading On War, the 1940 edition.

After the outbreak of the Chinese People's War of Resistance Against Japanese Aggression, Fu Daqing (傅大庆, Fu Ta-ch'ing), who served as an interpreter for the Soviet Military Advisory Group in Chongqing, learned that Mao Zedong (毛泽东, Mao Tse-tung) was studying Clausewitz in Yan'an but lacked a satisfactory Chinese translation. He immediately volunteered to

translate the work from the third Russian edition. His two-volume Chinese translation of *On War* was published by the Academic Press in November 1940, and he arranged for it to be sent to Yan'an. This edition was praised by Zhu De (朱德, Chu Te) and Ye Jianying (叶剑英, Yeh Chien-ying) as the best translation available at the time, and Mao Zedong also read it. No physical photographs of this edition available.

In March 1941, the Military and Political Journal Press of the Eighth Route Army reprinted Qu's translation into three volumes and renamed it *On War*. However, the original author was translated as "克劳什维兹".

克勞什維茲

戰爭論

(第一冊)

版出社誌雜政軍軍陸八

The 1941 edition.

克勞什維茲「戰爭論」俄文版序

我們社會上一般人士對於克勞什維茲之理論著作發生很濃厚的興趣，這就是他這基本著述「戰爭論」第三版問世的緣因。克勞什維茲對他這本書曾說過：

「如果拙著於兩三年之後尚未被人們忘懷，而學好斯學者又能展讀而不釋卷，這實是我之懷抱也」。

克勞什維茲這種希望，完全成爲事實了：其名著在百年以上的流芳問世，已臻著者於偉大的軍事理論家與軍事哲學家應享的光榮地位。

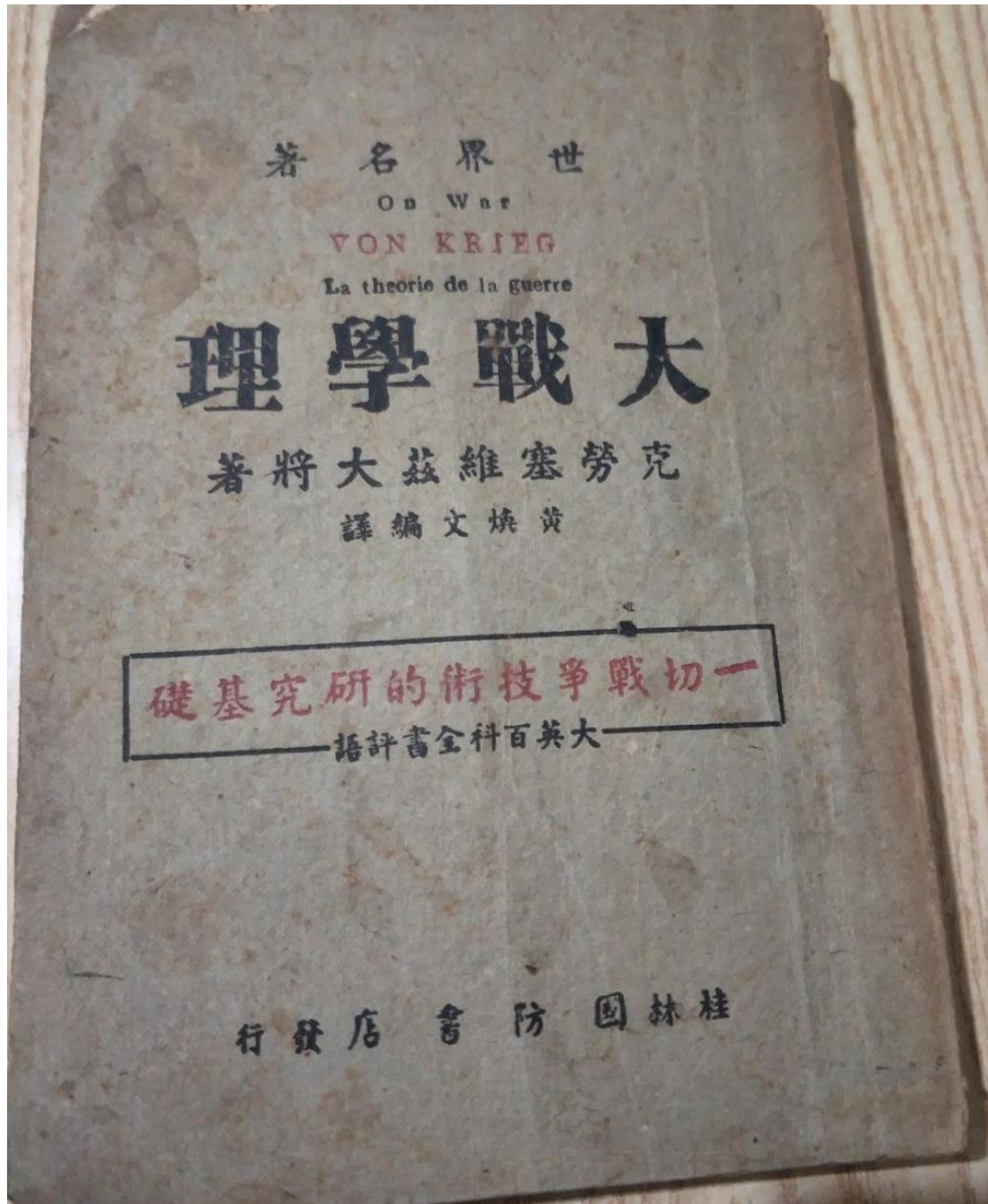
克勞什維茲是偉大的資產階級革命同時代的人。甲可實爲人底專政，將法國國底封建農奴制度打得粉碎。在革命中所創造出來的新軍，不但勝利地拯救法國於反動歐洲底四方夾攻之下，且以大無畏的精神用自已底武器爲新社會制度掃清了一條道路。恩格斯說：「法國國底革命軍隊將起驅逐了貴族、僧侶與小諸侯等……他們新創被縛，確不曾爲一個荒蕪的開路先鋒」。舊式貴族底特權到處根絕，革命風潮底熱流，到處激盪了被壓迫的與破產的農民以及窮途末路的市民。

法國革命底政治思想對普魯士的克勞什維茲實族，不啻爲洪水猛獸。在這方面，克氏並不比他不階級人們高超。卡爾·芬——克勞什維茲爲保皇黨。他畢生實際的軍事活動，都是刻勞於歐洲底反動派。一七九三年克勞什維茲還是十四歲的小孩時，即加入萊因同盟反對革命的法國。一八〇六年，他參加了反拿破崙的戰爭，一八二二年，克勞什維茲脫離普魯士軍而轉到俄皇亞歷山大第一方面服役。他在俄國一直服務到一八一四年，參

Preface to the Russian Edition of Clausewitz's *On War* in Chinese.

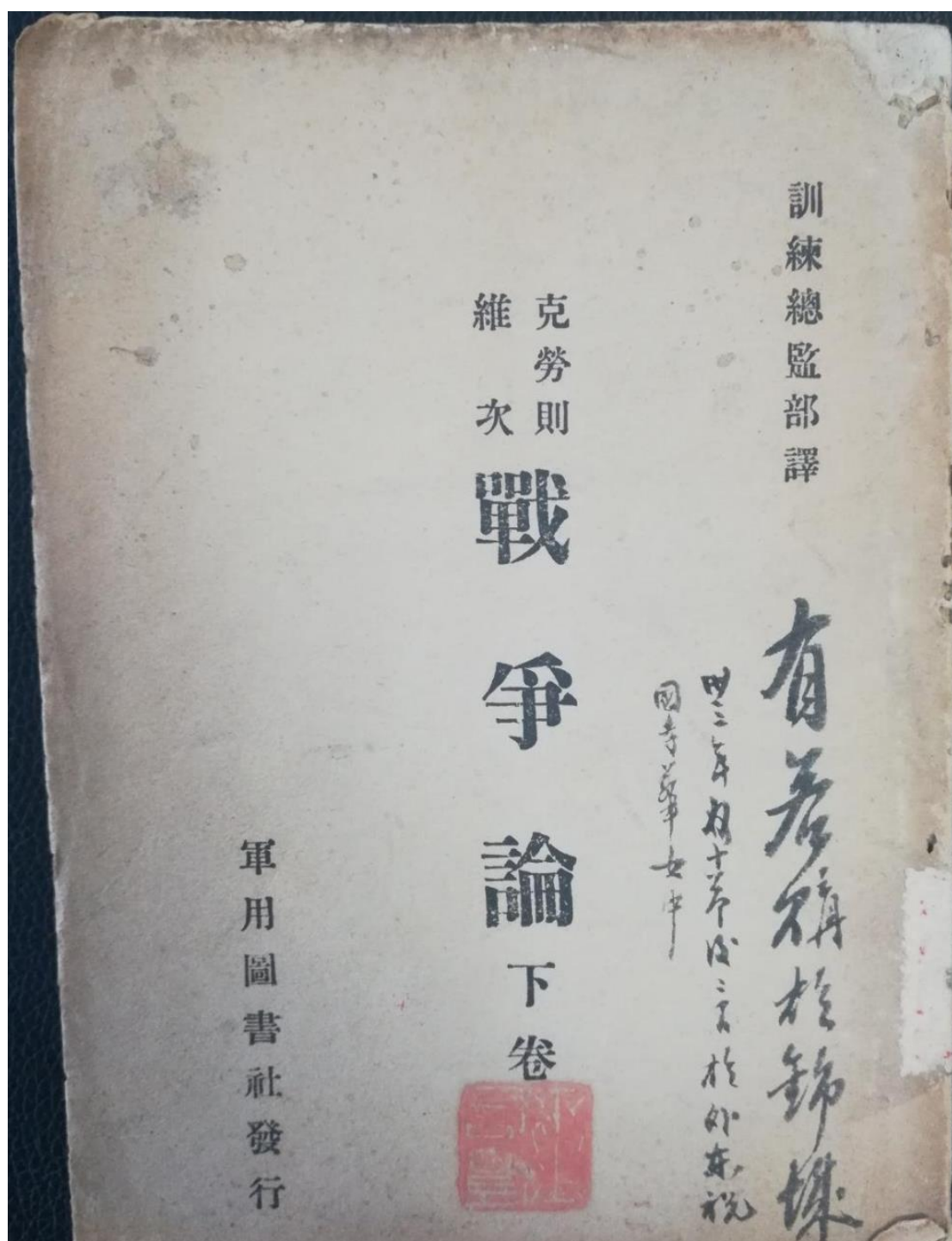
In the same year, the National Defense Bookstore of Guilin published the compiled and translated edition — "大战学理" — by Huang Huanwen (黄煥)

文, Huang Huan-wen). In this edition, he referred to Clausewitz (“克勞塞維茲”) not as a “Major General”, but a “General” and quoted comments from the *Encyclopædia Britannica*, describing the book as "the foundational study of all military art".



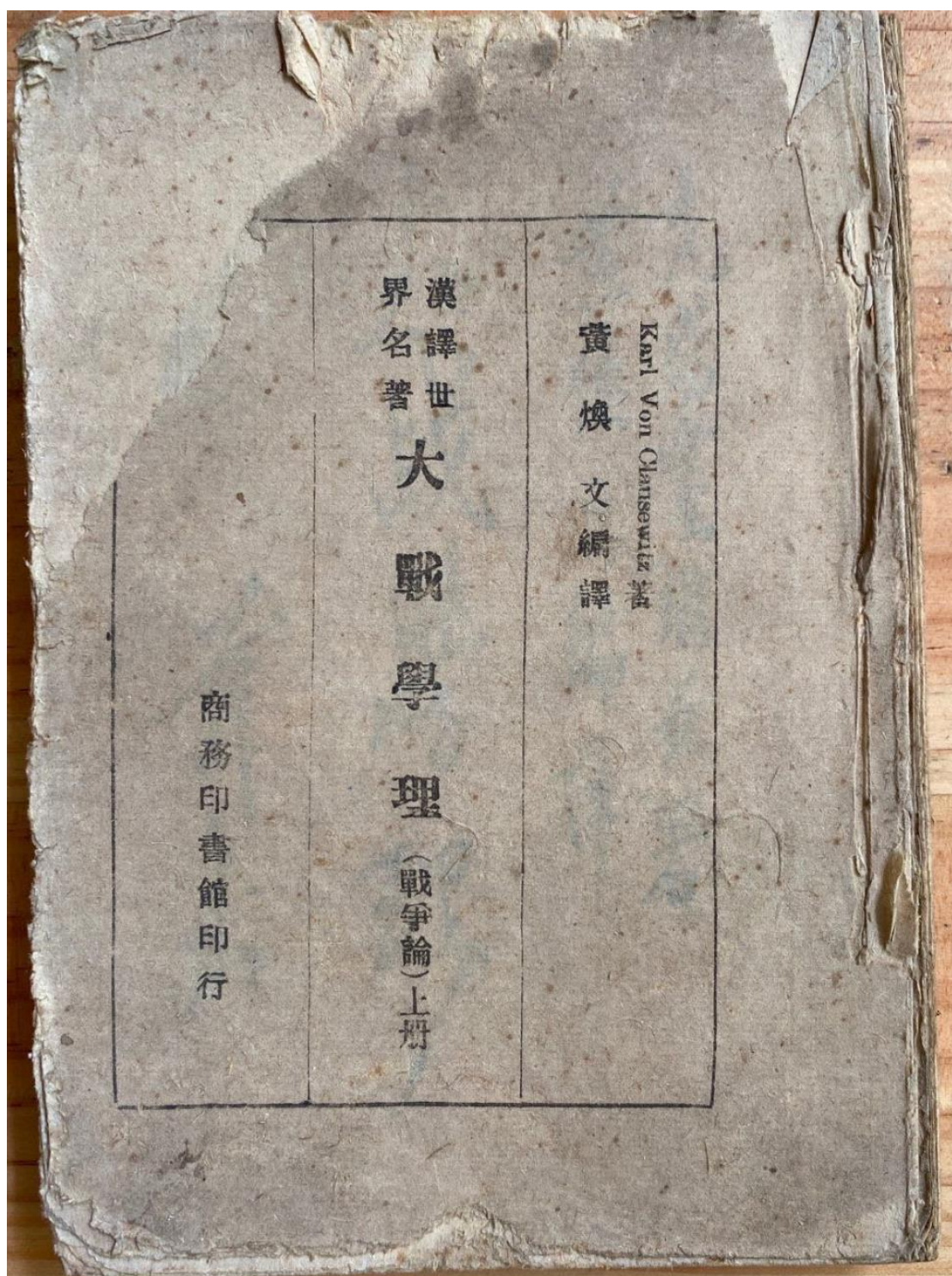
The 1941 edition of Huang.

In April 1942, the Military Translation and Compilation Office of the Training Supervision Department of the Kuomintang (KMT) of China translated and published the two-volume edition of *On War* based on Magome Kennosuke's Japanese translation. And the original author was translated as "克劳则维次".

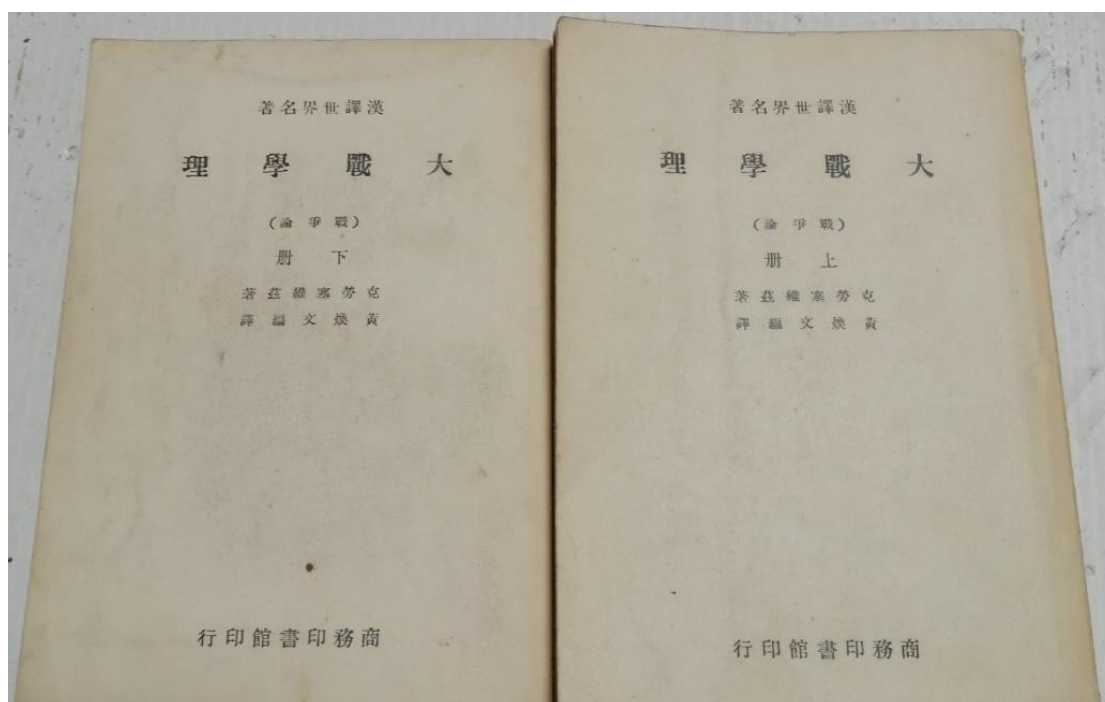


The 1942 edition.

In 1944, the Commercial Press in Chongqing published Huang's translation — "大战学理" — with the subtitle "战争论". Two years later, the Commercial Press in Shanghai reissued it as a two-volume edition.



Presumably the 1944 edition.



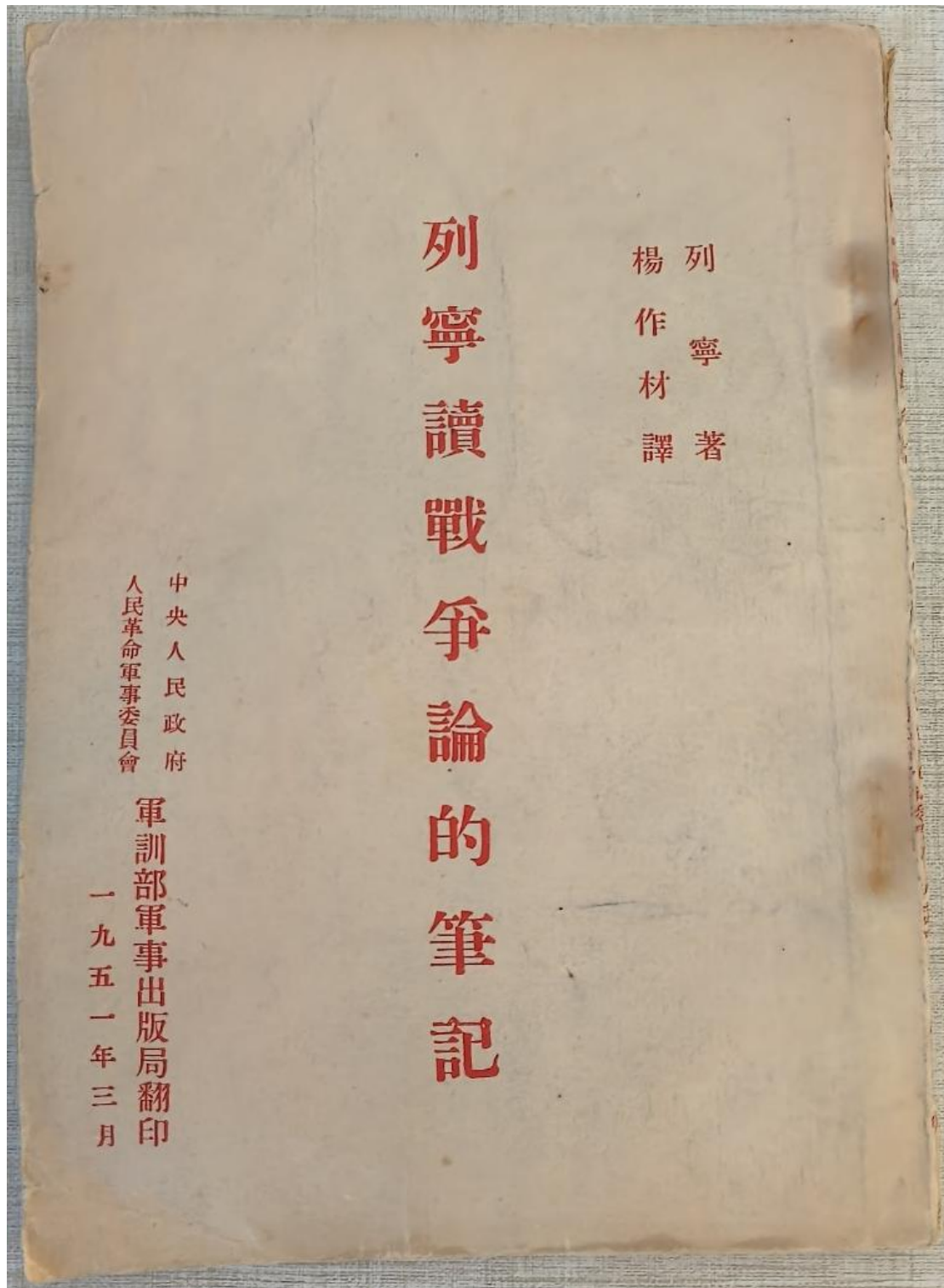
Presumably the 1946 edition.

In 1947, another translation titled "大战原理" (Principles of Major Operations) translated by Li Yuri (李浴日, Li Yü-jih) was published. And the original author was translated as "克劳塞维兹". This translated edition is an abridged outline of *On War*, rendered from the Japanese version translated by Narita Yoritake (成田赖武), and was compiled together with Li's research essays on *The Art of War*.



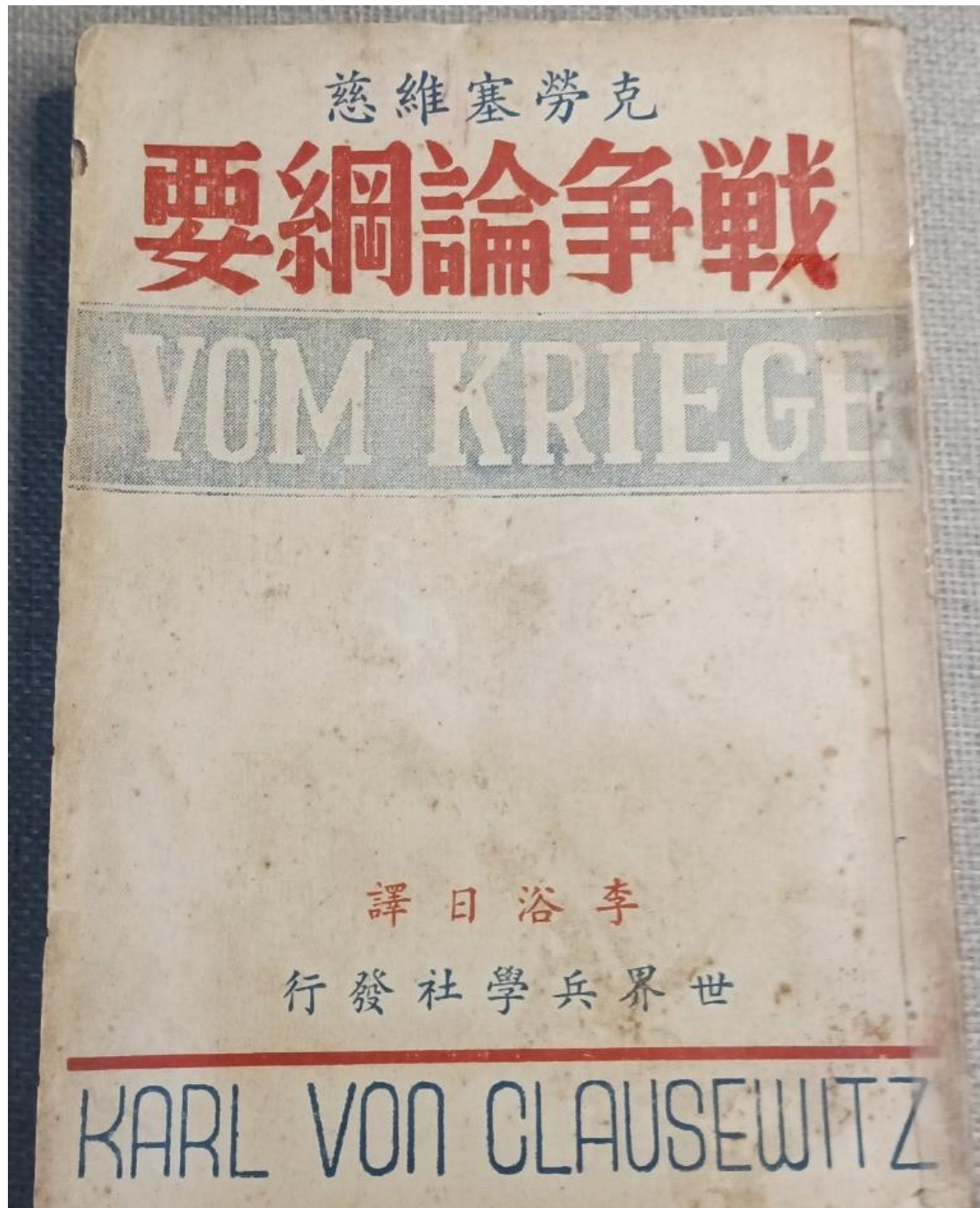
The 1947 edition.

Two years later, the Kuomintang of China was defeated by the Communist Party of China in the Civil War and retreated to Taiwan. In the early days of the People's Republic of China, *On War* was not reprinted, yet Yang's *Lenin's Notes on Reading On War* was republished in March 1951.



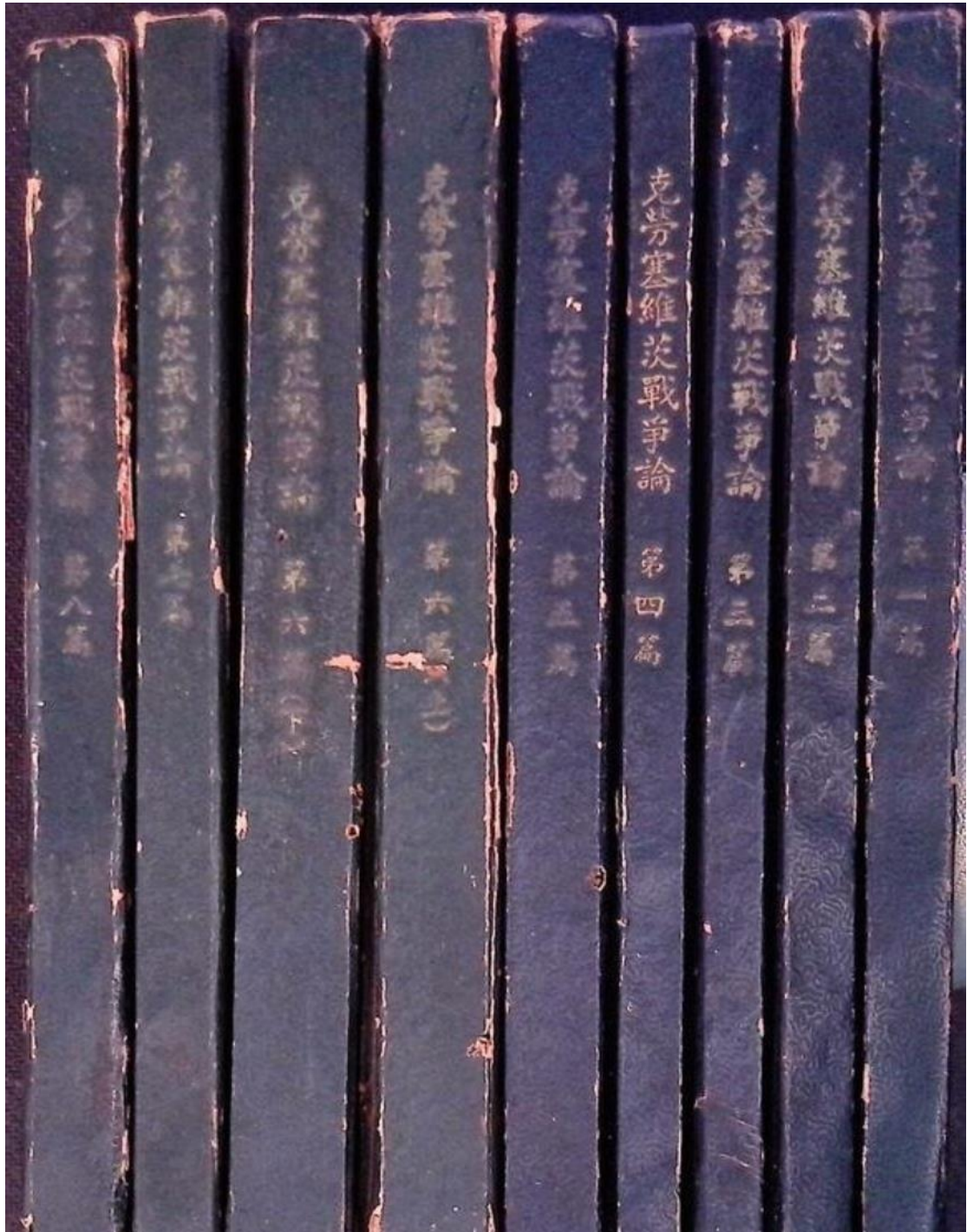
Lenin's Notes on Reading On War, the 1951 edition.

In 1951, *Outline of On War* by Li was published in Taiwan, China, which constituted a reprint of "大战原理".



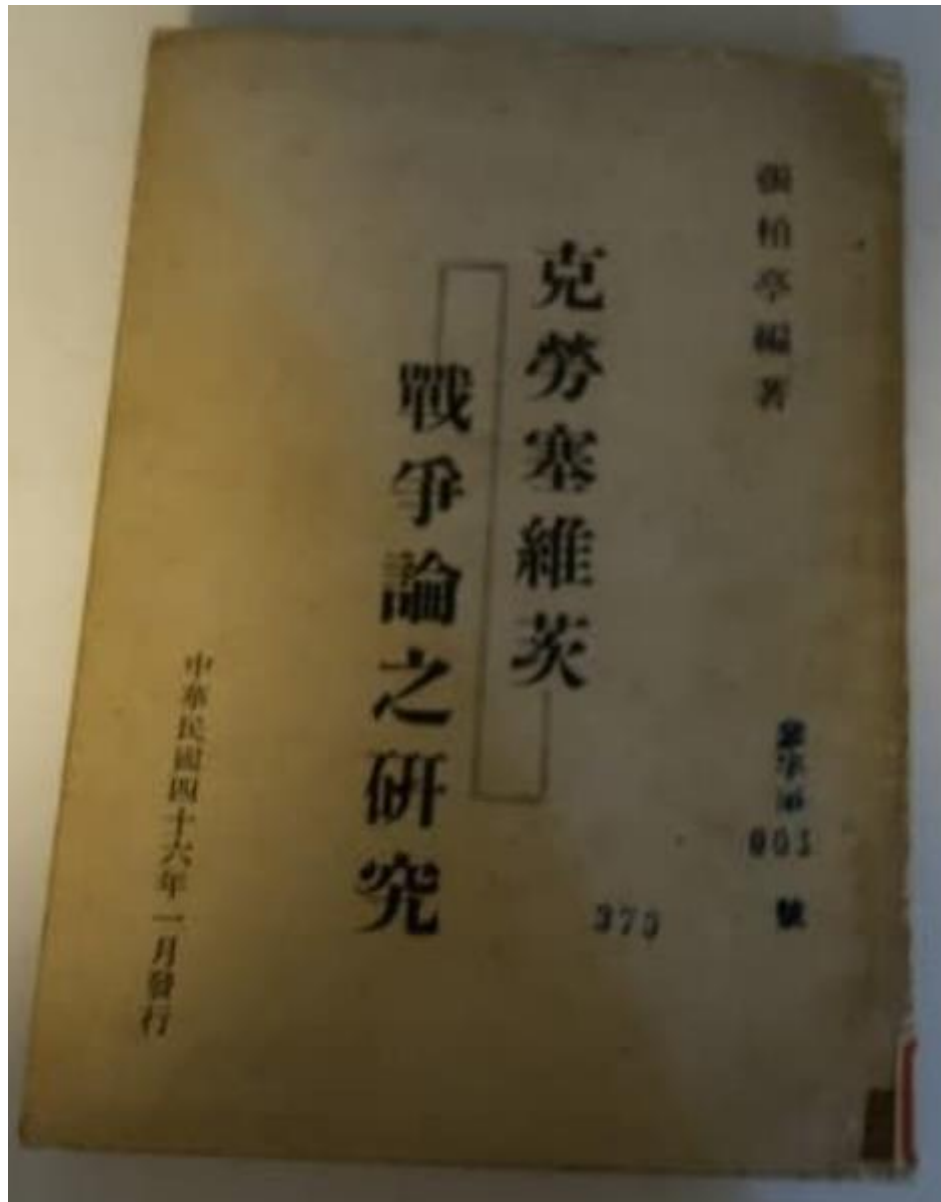
Outline of On War.

In 1956, an eight-volume edition of *On War* was published in Taiwan, China.



The 1956 edition.

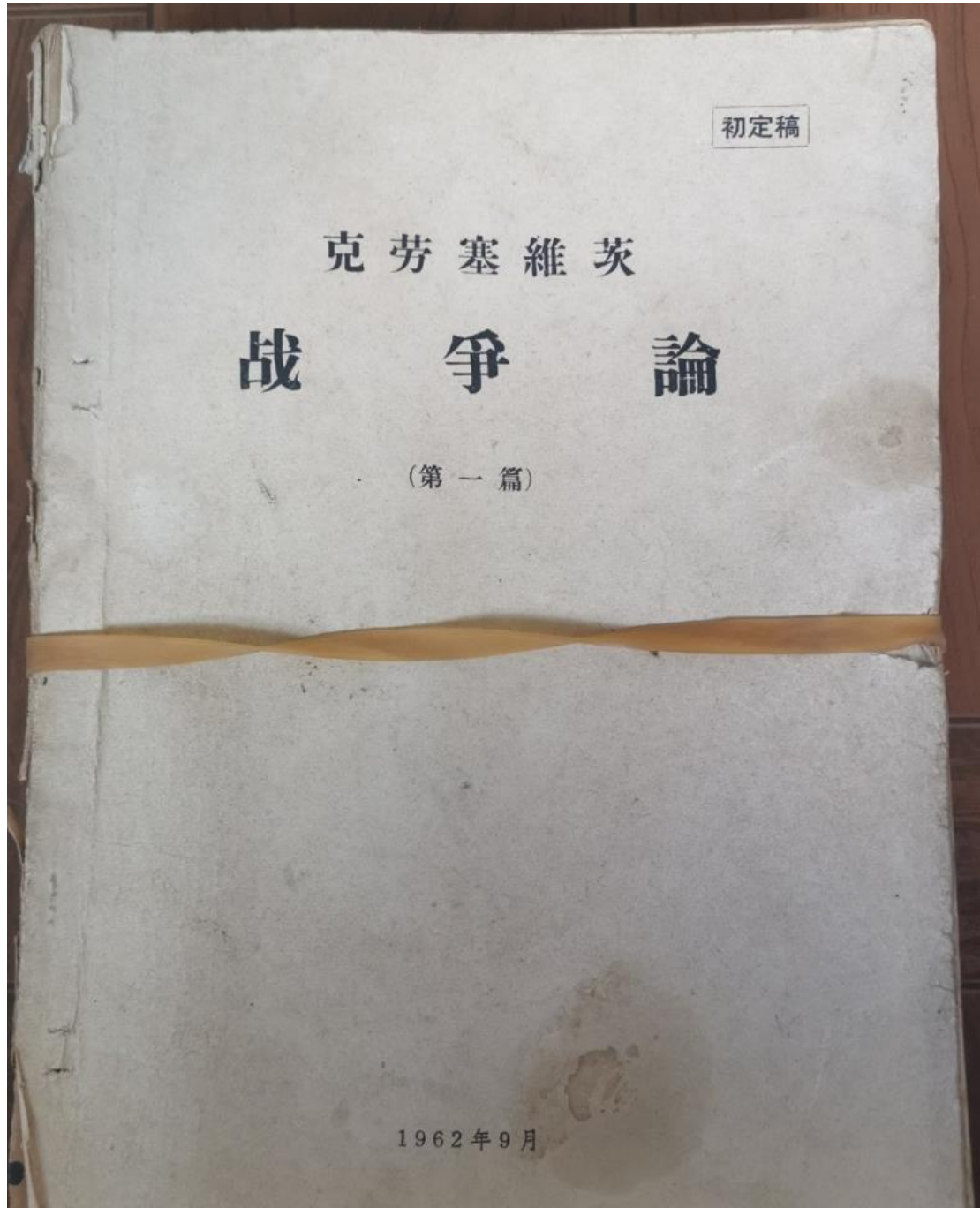
In next year, *A Study of Clausewitz's On War*, compiled and written by Zhang Boting (张柏亭, Chang Po-t'ing), was published in Taiwan, China.



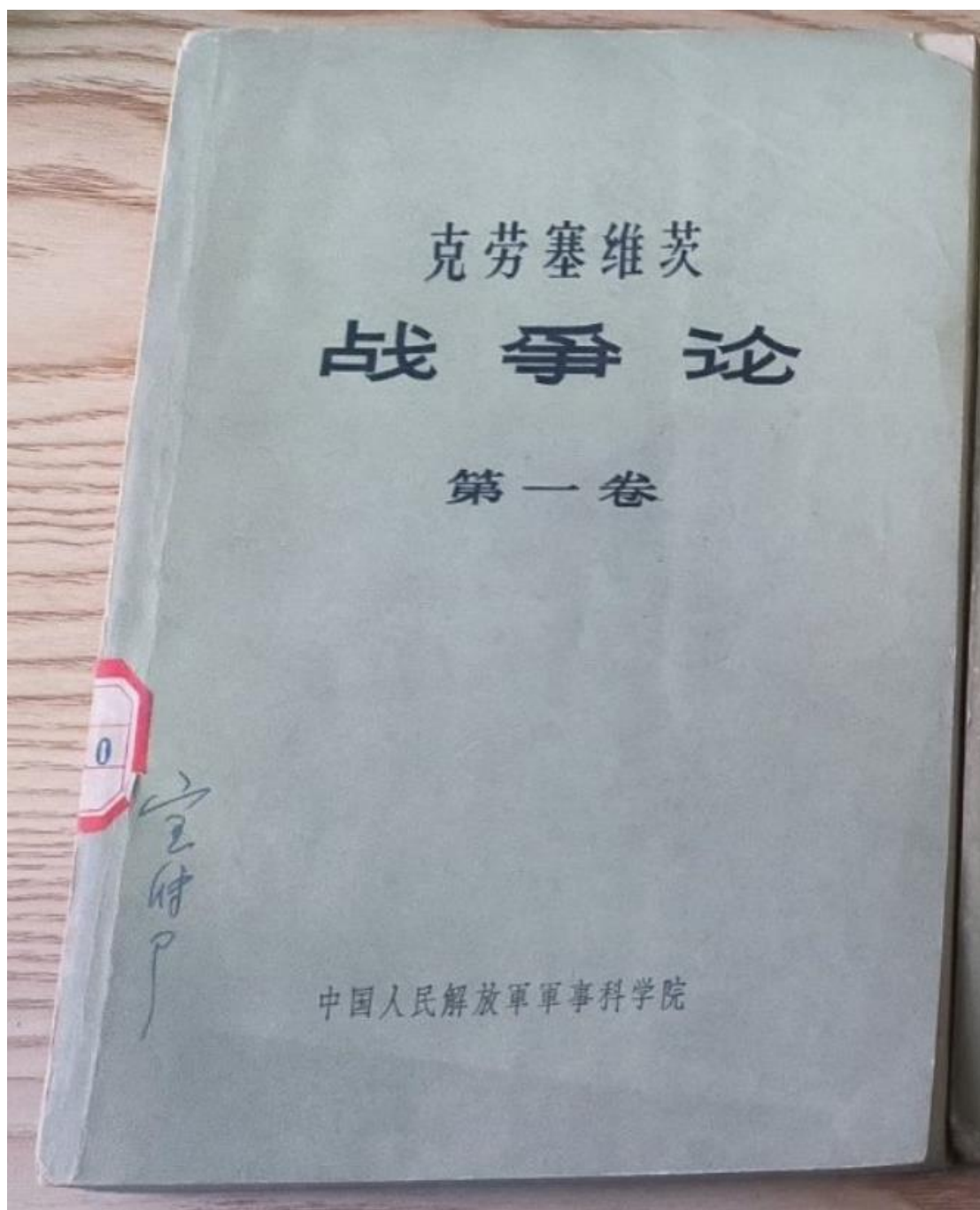
A Study of Clausewitz's On War.

In February 1960, the Academy of Military Science of the Chinese People's Liberation Army began translating *On War* in accordance with instructions from the Central Military Commission. The work was initially rendered from the Russian translation; however, numerous errors were found in the Russian version. It was therefore decided to base the translation on the 1957 German edition issued by the Ministry of National Defense of the former German Democratic Republic, while cross-referencing translations in major languages including Russian, Japanese, French and English, as well as several existing Chinese translations for collation. The translation spanned three years

from 1961 to 1964. Volumes I to III of *On War* were successively published for internal circulation by the Publishing Bureau of the General Staff Department between February 1964 and April 1965.



The finalized eight-volume draft issued internally in September 1962.

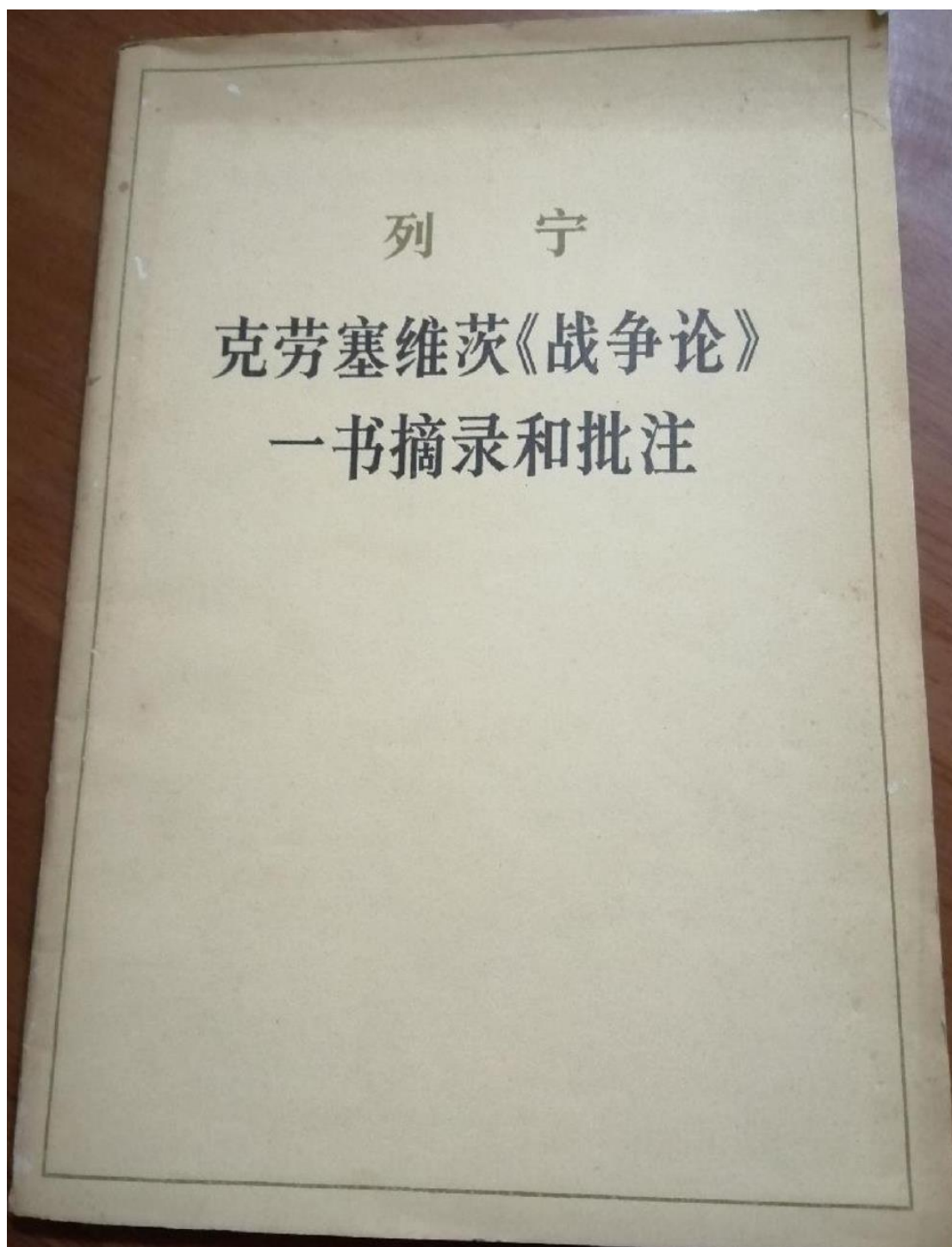


First edition: February 1964.



First edition: February 1964; second printing: October 1985.

In April 1960, the Chinese mainland published Lenin's work *Excerpts and Annotations on Clausewitz's On War*.



Lenin's Excerpts and Annotations on Clausewitz's On War.

In 1977, the Academy of Military Science further abridged the complete text of *On War*, condensing the original over 690,000 characters into 89,000 characters. This abridged version was first published by the Warrior Publishing House in April 1978 for internal distribution.

克劳塞维茨
战争论
(删节本)

中国人民解放军军事科学院

On War (abridged version).

In 1978, the Commercial Press included the complete translated Volumes 1 to 3 of *On War* in the series of *Chinese Translation of World Academic Masterpieces* and published it publicly.



The 1978 edition of the Commercial Press.



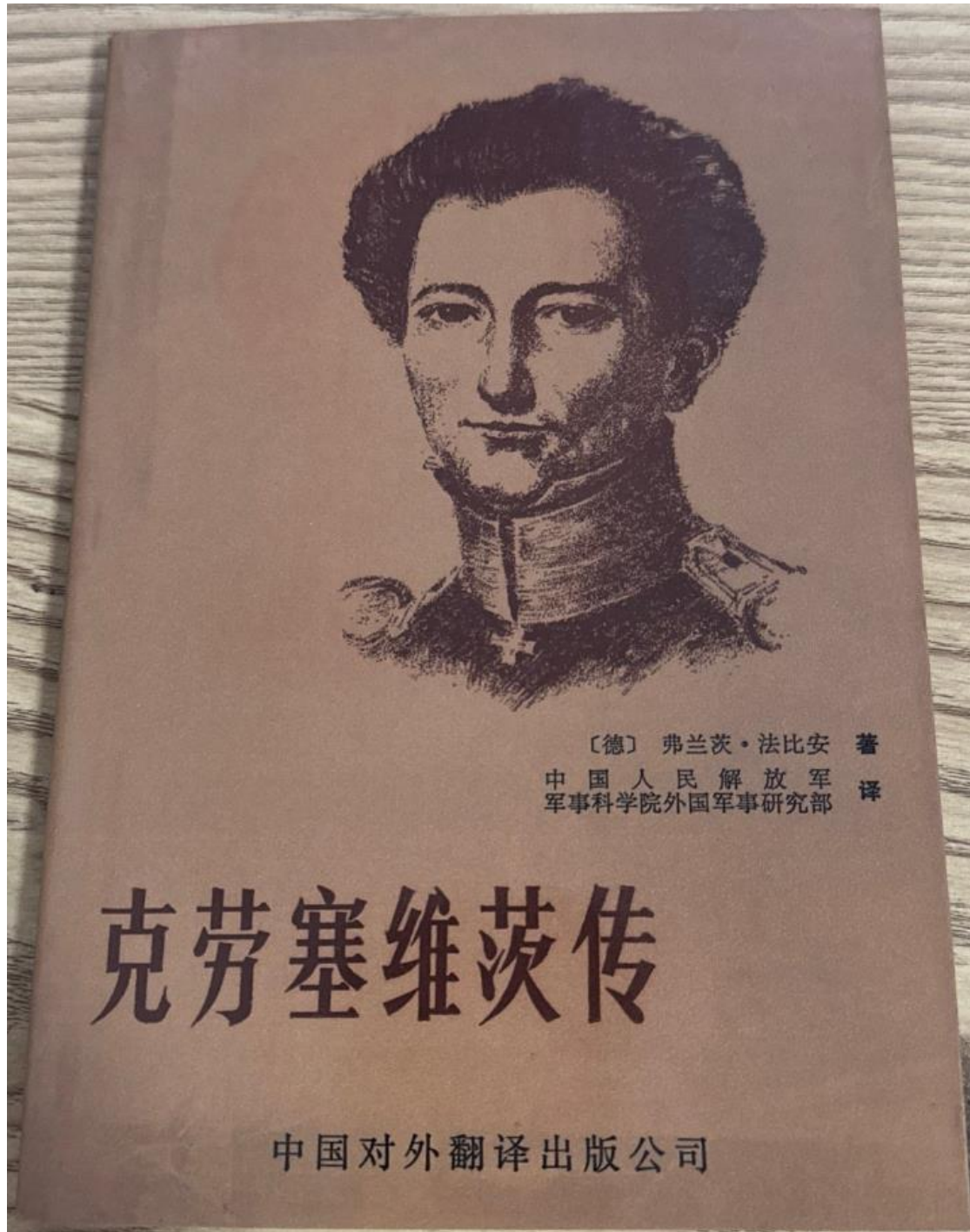
The 1995 edition of the Commercial Press.

In 1980, *The Complete Works of On War* translated by Niu Xianzhong (钮先钟, Niu Hsien-chung) was published in Taiwan, China.



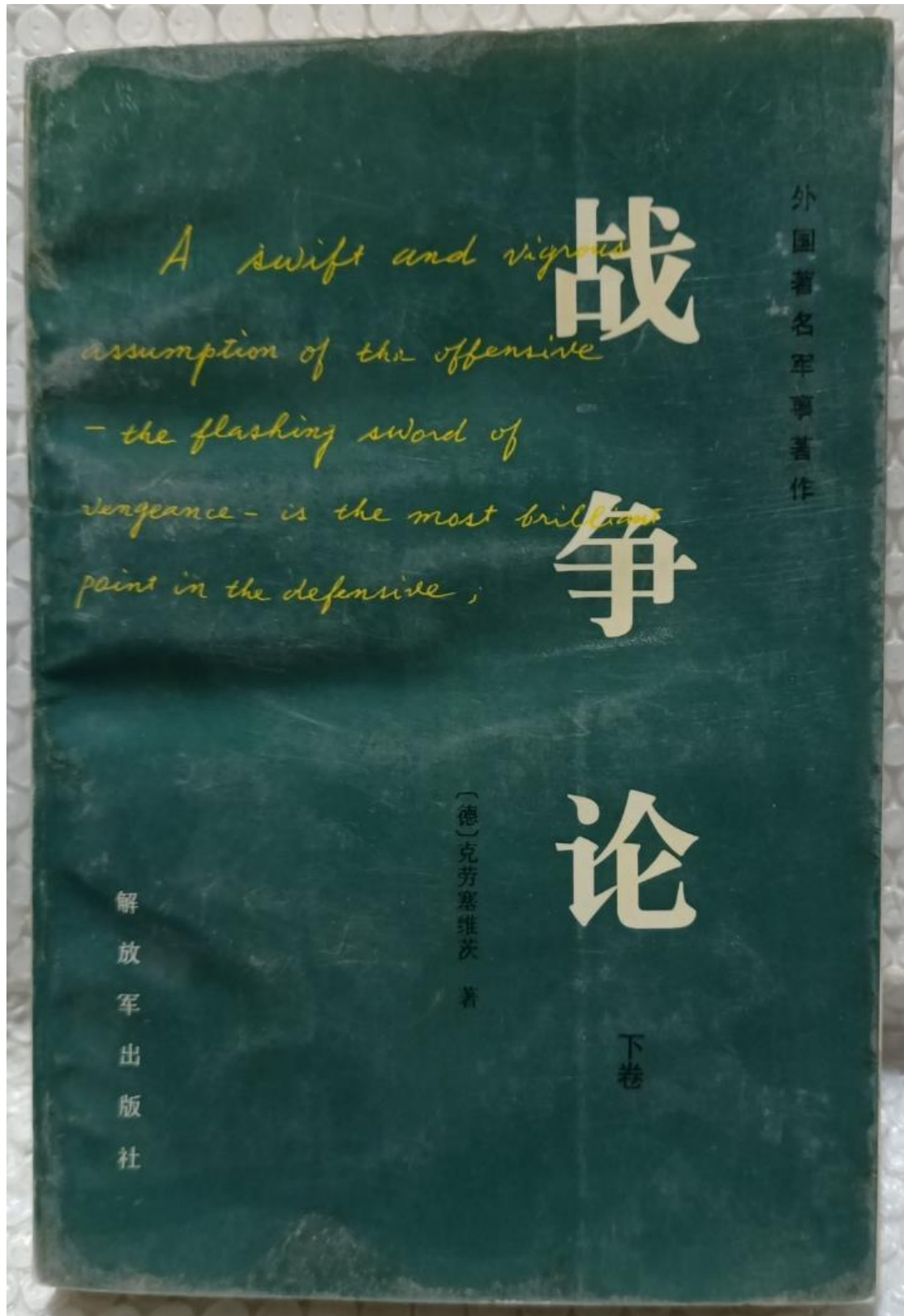
The 1980 edition.

In 1984, the Foreign Military Studies Department of the Academy of Military Science of the Chinese People's Liberation Army translated *Clausewitz: Leben und Werk* by Franz Fabian.



Fabian's *Clausewitz: Leben und Werk*.

In 1985, the PLA Publishing House made minor revisions to the complete translated Volumes 1 to 3 of *On War*, included it in the series of *Famous Foreign Military Works*, and reprinted the book.



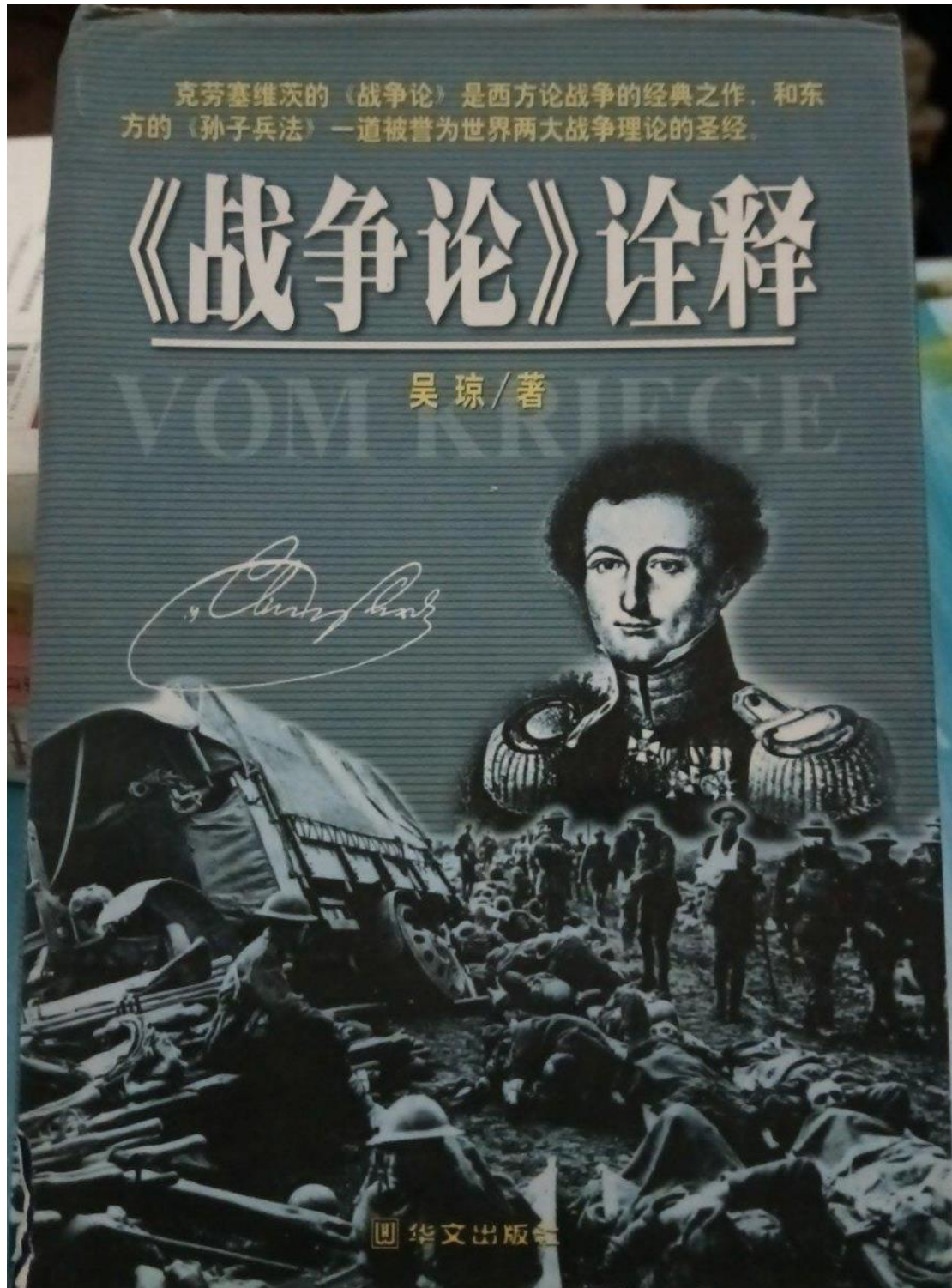
On War in the series of *Famous Foreign Military Works*.

In 1995, the Commercial Press published the Chinese translation of *Clausewitz: Leben und Werk* by Wilhelm von Schramm.



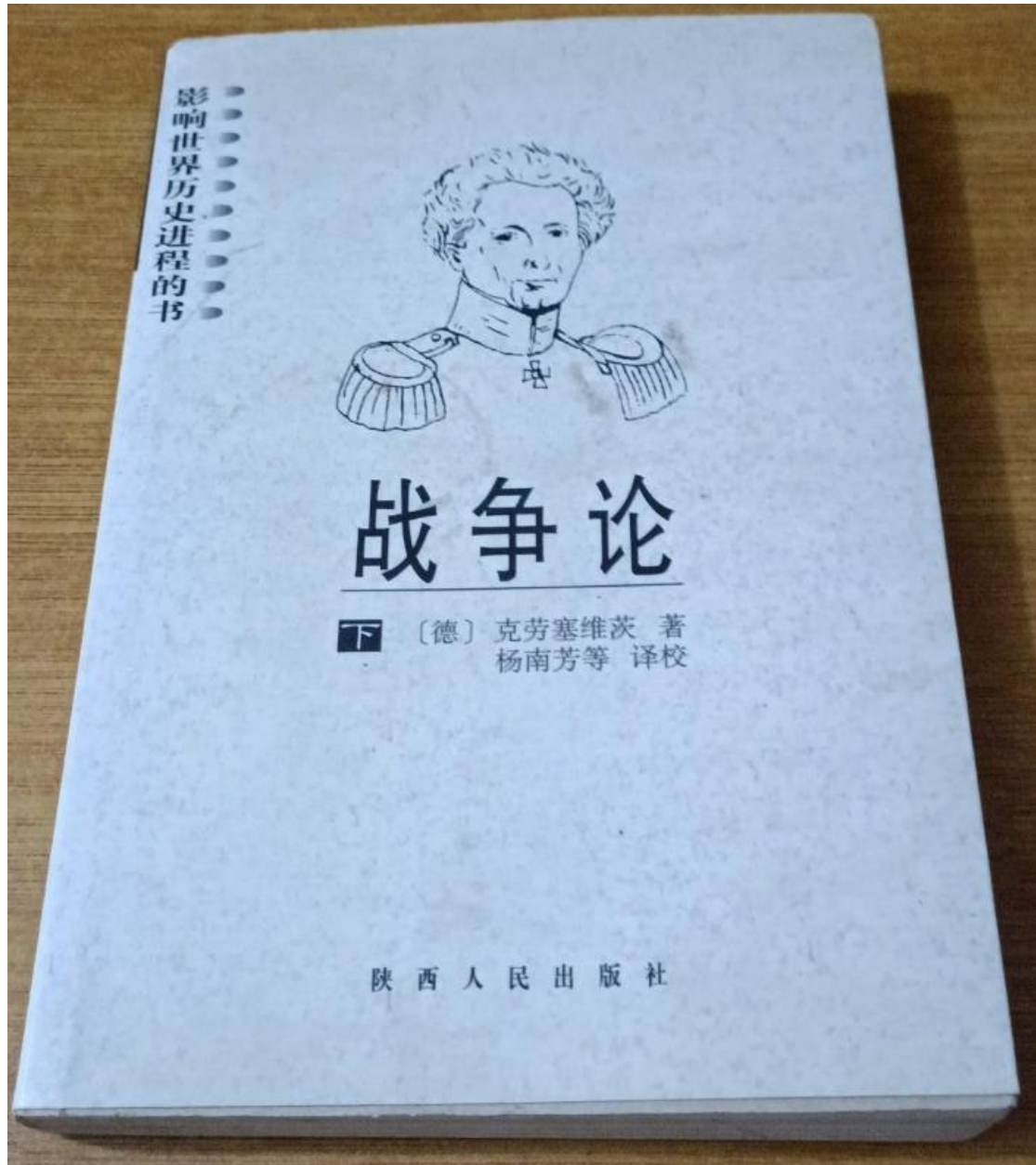
Schramm's *Clausewitz: Leben und Werk*.

In 2000, Huawen Publishing House published *An Interpretation of On War* by Wu Qiong (吴琼). The author, a postgraduate student majoring in philosophy, began writing this book in 1983 and spent seventeen years completing it with five major revisions. Taking the philosophical methodology in *On War* as the key analytical perspective, the author reconstructs the complete theoretical system of Clausewitz's doctrine of war by integrating the developmental history of Western military thought, Marxist military science, and contemporary warfare issues. This work remains the first major military academic monograph at home and abroad that conducts systematic, accurate, in-depth research and objective evaluation on *On War*. The author expressed a wish in the book: "It is hoped that more people from diverse disciplines, especially young people, will engage in this meaningful research endeavor." It was also after an in-depth study of this book that I completed my pivotal wargaming research paper *On Wargaming*. 【 References 1 】



An Interpretation of On War.

In 2001, Shaanxi People's Publishing House issued *On War*, translated and revised by Yang Nanfang (杨南芳) et al.



The 2001 edition.

In 2003, the PLA Publishing House published *Commentary on On War* by Xia Zhengnan (夏征难). 【 References 2 】

世界·军事·名著·导读·系列·丛书

解读《战争论》

Commentary on On the War

夏征难◇著



解放军出版社

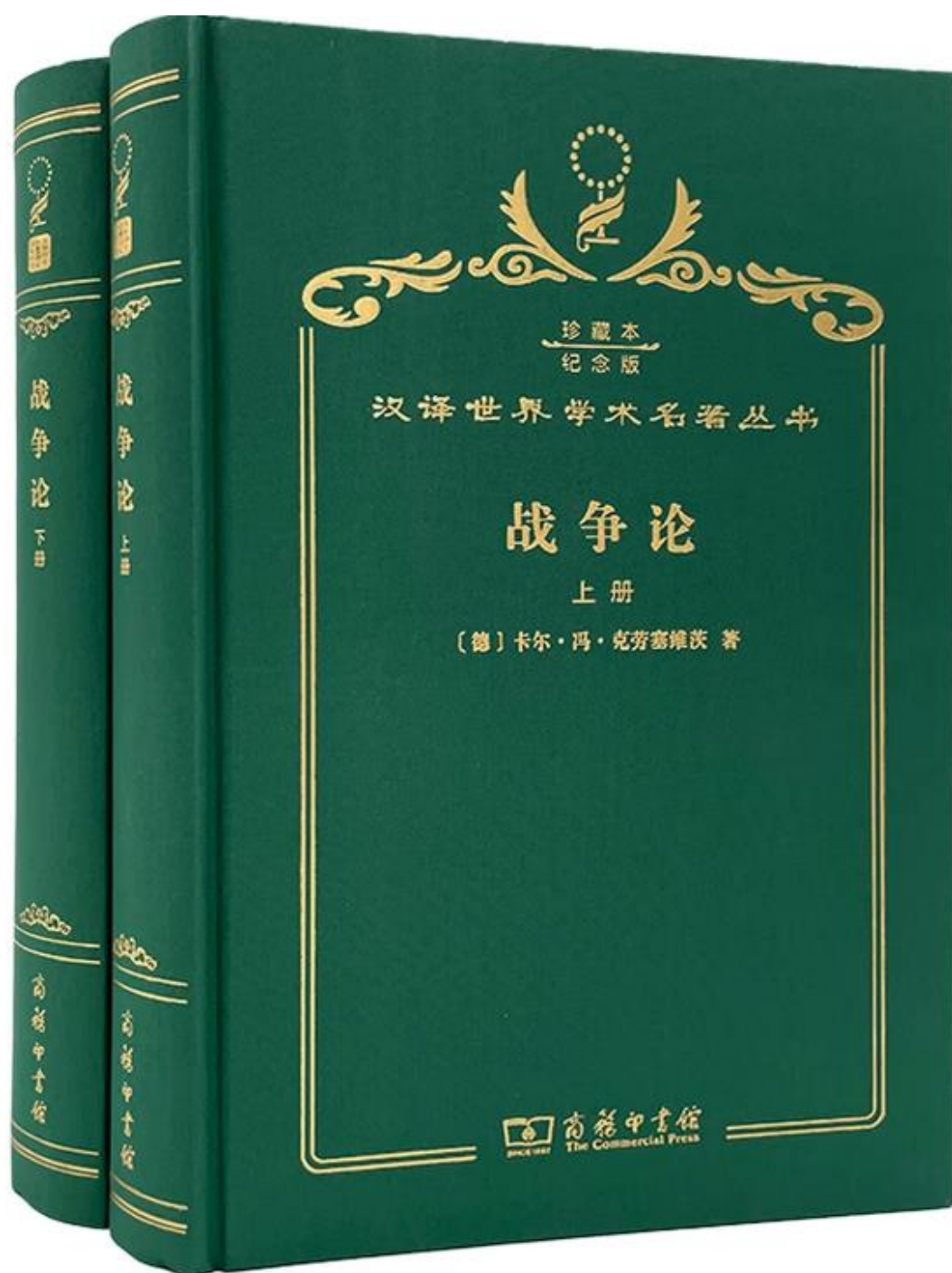
Commentary on On War.

In 2016, the Commercial Press replaced the existing version of *On War* in the series of *Chinese Translation of World Academic Masterpieces* with a two-

volume edition translated by Shi Yinhong (时殷弘). This new translation was rendered from the English edition published by Princeton University Press.

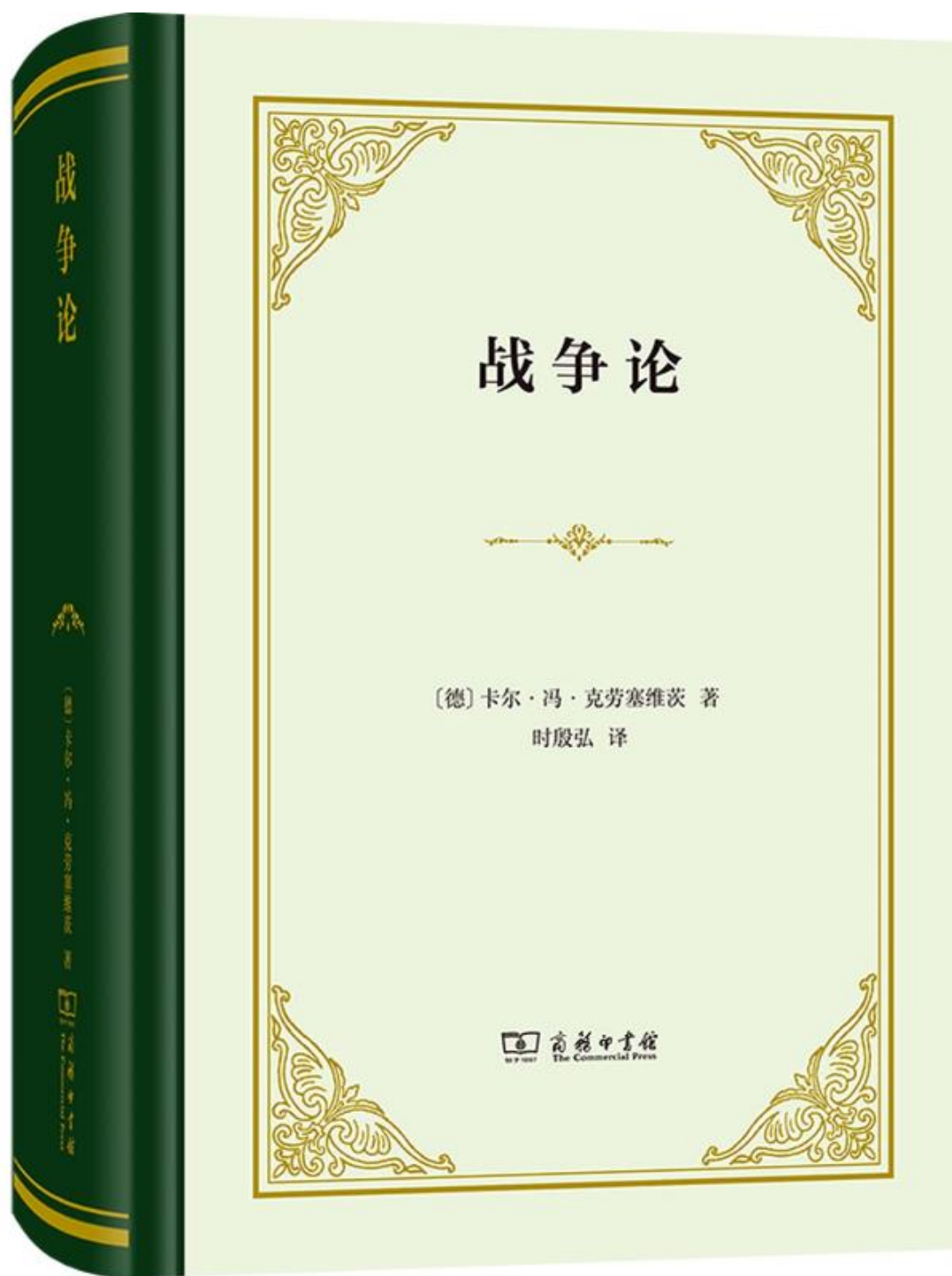


The 2019 edition of the Commercial Press.



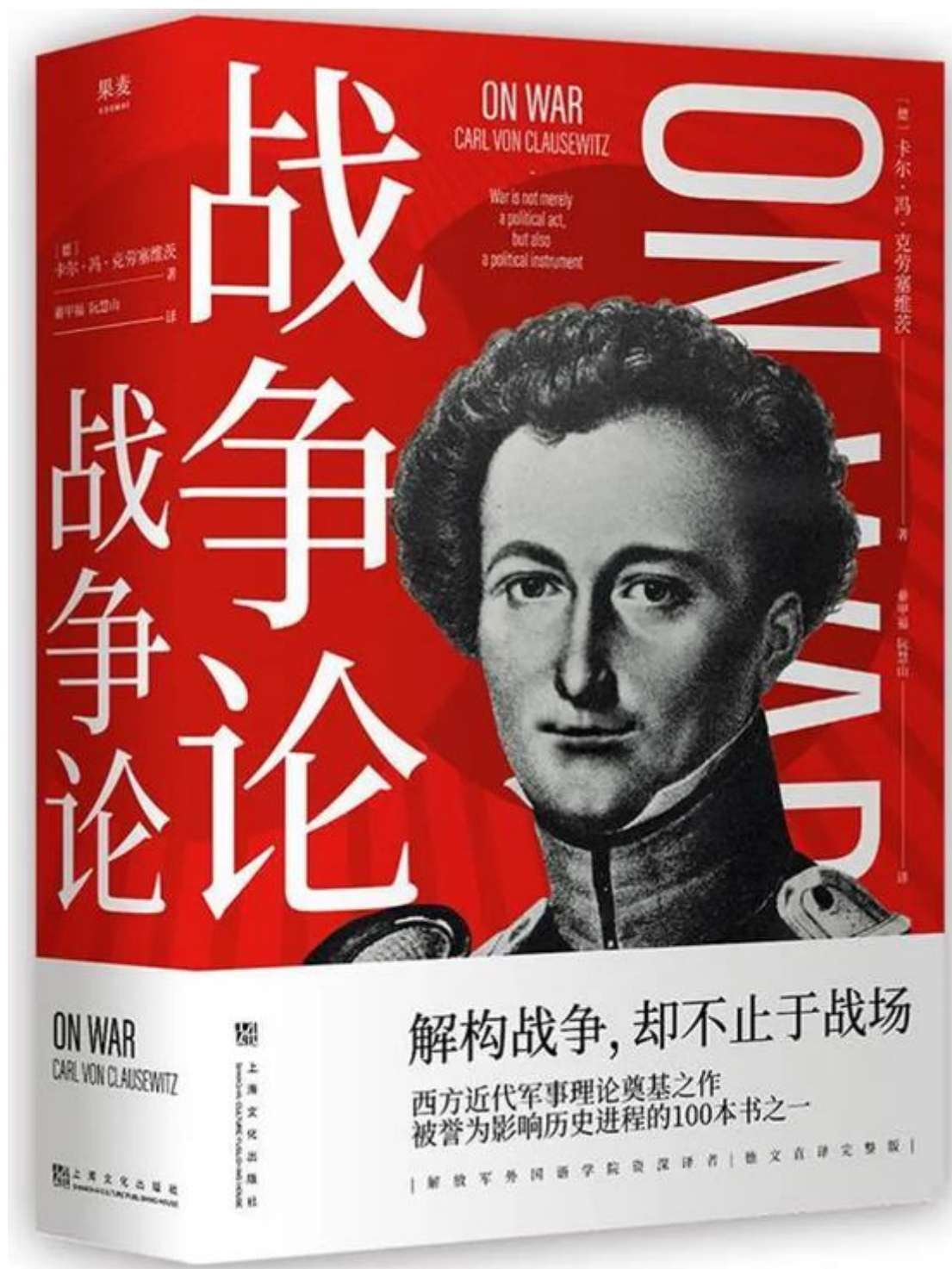
Two-volume commemorative edition of the Commercial Press.

In 2022, the Commercial Press released a one-volume edition based on the two-volume version.



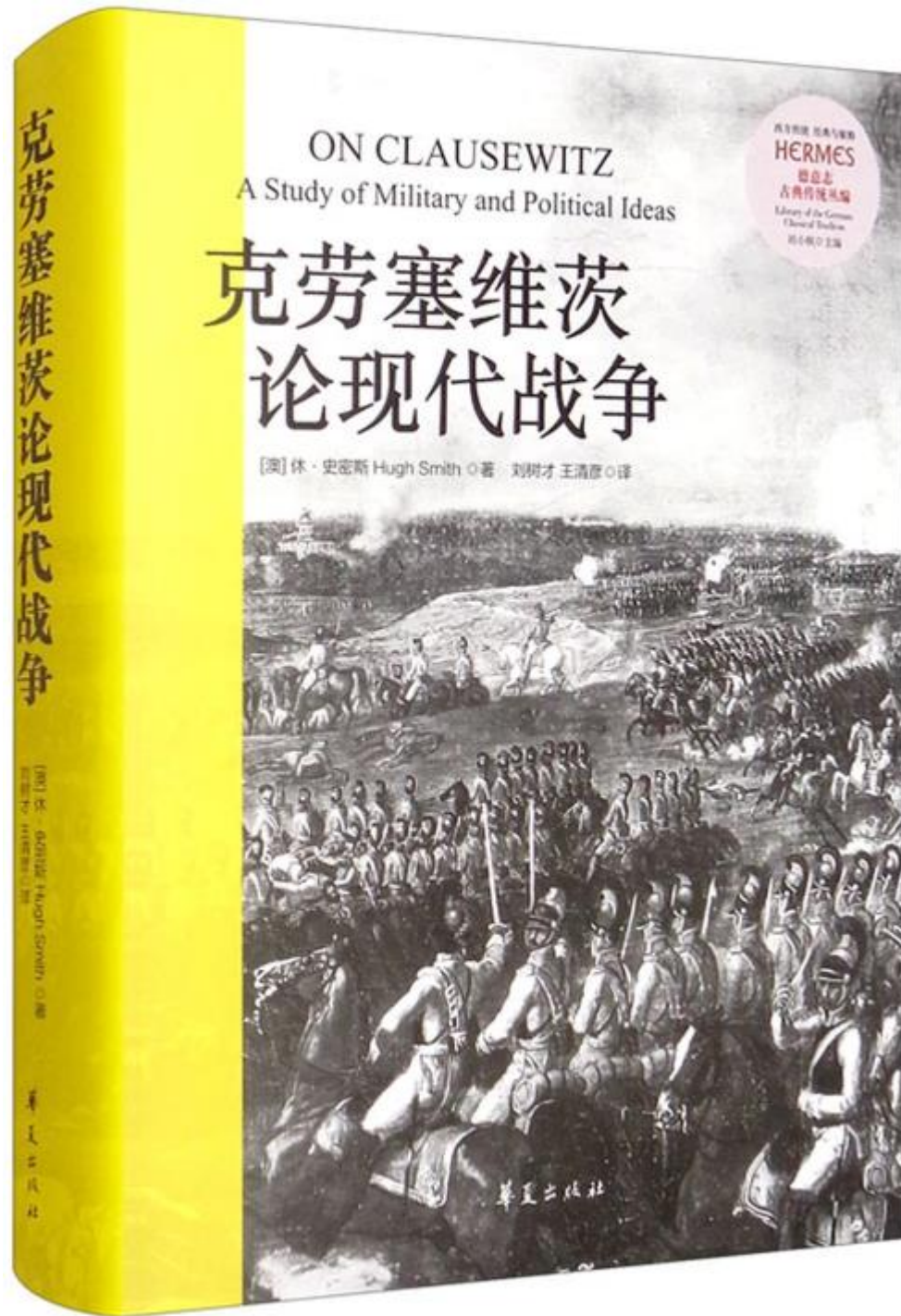
Single-volume commemorative edition of the Commercial Press.

In this year, Shanghai Culture Publishing House released a single-volume edition of *On War*, translated by Qi Jiafu (綦甲福) and Ruan Huishan (阮慧山). This edition is a reprint of the 2011 version, and both authors were among the original group of contributors.



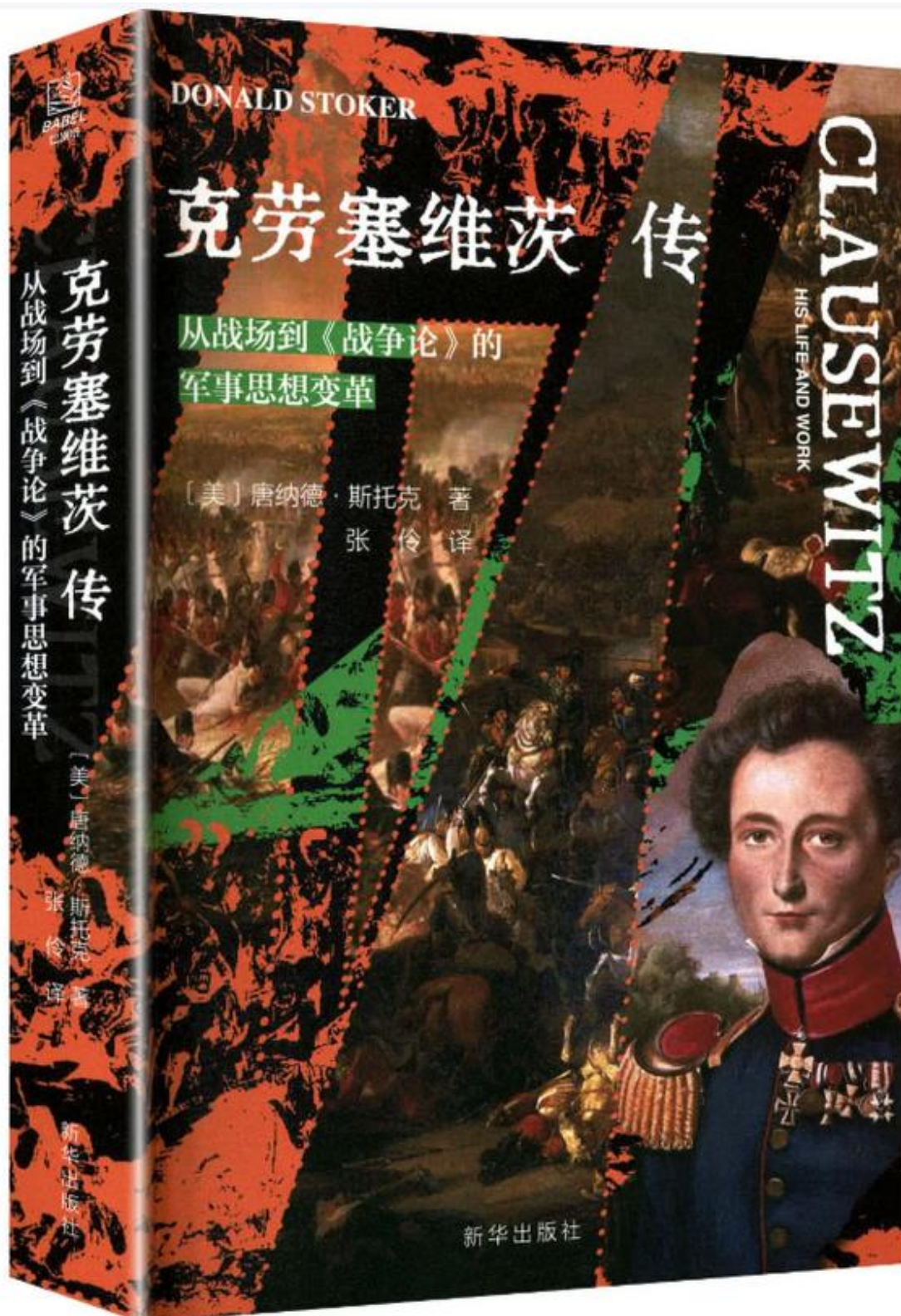
Qi Jiafu and Ruan Huishan's *On War*.

In the same year, Huaxia Publishing House published *On Clausewitz: A Study of Military and Political Ideas* by Hugh Smith.



Smith's *On Clausewitz: A Study of Military and Political Ideas*.

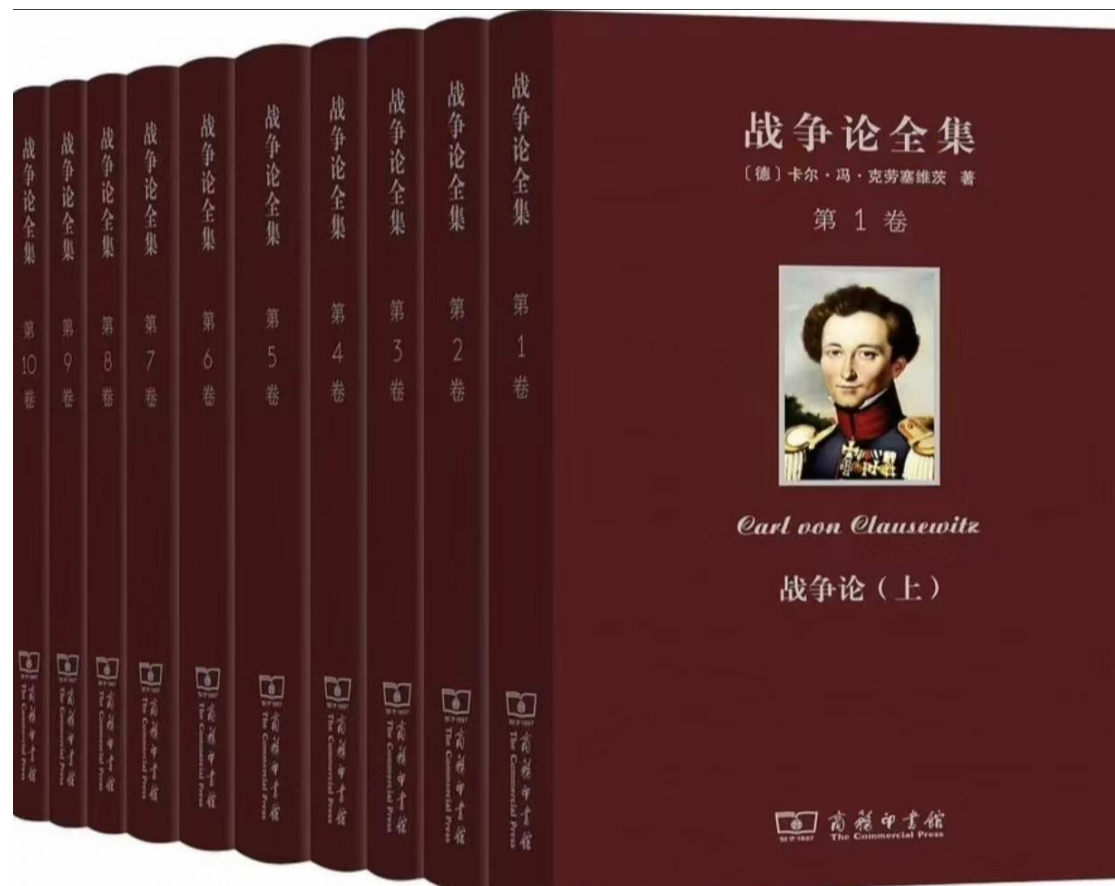
In 2025, Xinhua Publishing House released the Chinese edition of *Clausewitz: His Life and Work* by Donald Stoker.



Stoker's *Clausewitz: His Life and Work*.

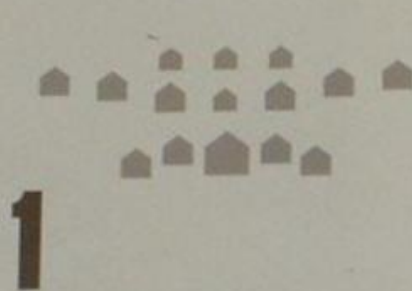
Before 2018, the China Institute for International Strategic Studies organized the translation of the ten-volume posthumous works of General Carl

von Clausewitz, titled *Posthumous Writings on War and the Conduct of War*, with Chen Chuan (陈川) as the translator. For unknown reasons, the complete collection failed to be published as originally planned. Chen Chuan thereafter delivered the full translated manuscript to the Commercial Press for publication, which released the ten-volume red-bound edition in 2018. Subsequently, the China Institute for International Strategic Studies requested the Commercial Press to recall this complete collection from the market. Chen Chuan then extracted the first three volumes of the translation and entrusted them to the Democracy and Construction Press for separate publication in 2020. Meanwhile, supplementing the full collection with the three-volume Commercial Press version, the China Institute for International Strategic Studies launched a newly revised white-bound complete edition through the PLA Publishing House in 2023.



The red-bound edition of the Complete Works.

ON WAR



战争论

西方近代军事理论的奠基之作
「西方兵圣」克劳塞维茨的不朽之书

改变历史的军事经典 商业决策的智慧要诀

国内初次根据 1832—1834 年

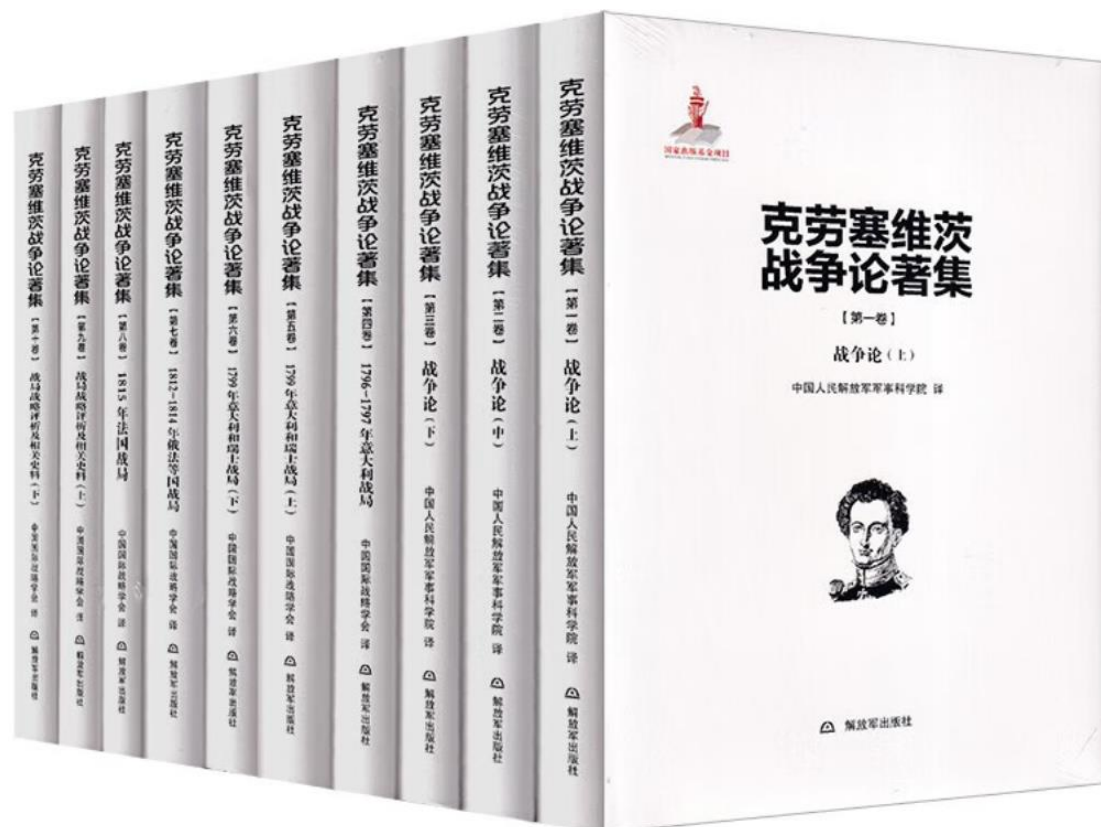
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民主与建设出版社 博雅天香

Chen Chuan's *On War*.



The white-bound edition of the Complete Works.